

Gita Mananam

Living the Gita — Daily Inspiration and Contemplation

Volume — 2

(Chapters 7 — 12)

Swāmī Nirguṇānanda Giri

Rishikesh, Uttarakhand, Bharat

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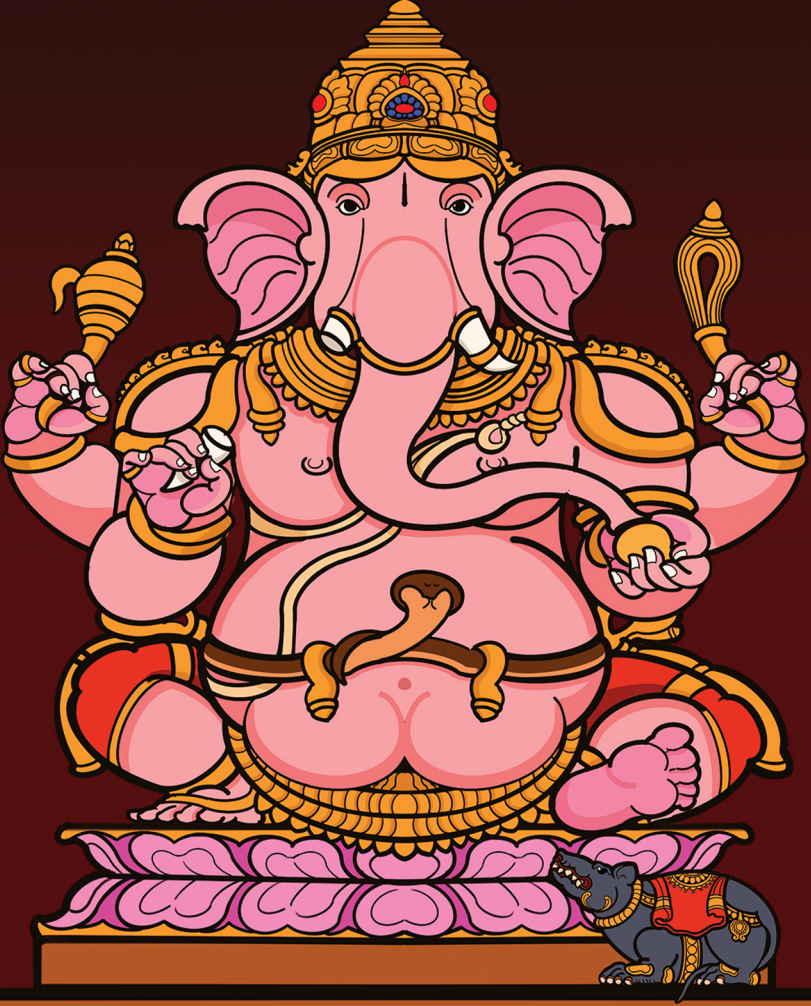
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Rishikesh, Bharat

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गजाननं भूतगणादि सेवितं कपित्थजम्बूफलसार भक्षितम् ।
उमासुतं शोकविनाशकारणं नमामि विघ्नेश्वर पादपङ्कजम् ॥



gajānanam bhūta-gaṇādi-sevitam kapittha-jambū-phala-sāra bhakṣitam ।
umā-sutam śoka-vināśa-kāraṇam namāmi vighneśvara pāda-paṅkajam ॥

Preface

दिशन्तु शं मे गुरुपादपांसवः

diśantu śaṁ me guru-pāda-pāṁsavah

May auspiciousness flow from the sacred dust of Guru's feet

Srimad Bhagavad Gita is a unique and unparalleled jewel among all scriptures. It serves as a guiding light not only for renunciants but also for those laden with worldly responsibilities, attempting to balance the material with the spiritual. It advocates them to be impartial with respect to the dealings of their body and mind, with which, out of ignorance, they become identified. It is a wrong notion that in order to accomplish one's duties in life, a sense of attachment is necessary. Lord Krishna, the greatest *saṁsārī* (an active worldly being) of all, is a perfect unattached *asamsārī* (a transcendental being). He demonstrates through his actions and words how to function in this tangible, material world while remaining grounded in sublime bliss.

To attain this state, one needs proper guidance from capable teachers who show the path that initially appears to be conflicting and full of challenges. As pointed out by the deep insight of the author of this master guide book in verses 52-53 of Ch 2: "The purpose of the teacher and scriptures is to shake us out of delusion. Confusion and challenges are a part of the spiritual journey as we let go of our worldly thinking patterns and seek refuge in the higher reality. As we thus progress, we begin to gain clarity on the path."

This book leads the readers, through the author's revolutionary contemplations, from body to mind and from mind to consciousness, penetrating the layers of one's existence. The introspective questions under the title *Mananam* in each section give no respite to those who are engaged in self appeasement and self-deceit (*ātmā pravacana*) and challenges them towards an honest self-assessment. On the other hand, the words under Inspiration serves as an inexhaustible source of positivity, making the arduous and confusing spiritual path relatively easier.

This handbook gives ample material for aspirants to find solution to the various issues of life, not outwardly but within oneself. The content of this book shows the profound understanding of the author on human psychology — progressing first to a positive mental state and then beyond it, to the innermost eternal Self. As the readers of this book embark on this journey, they are certain to surpass the domain of the human mind and arrive at the *adhiṣṭhāna caitanyam* (ultimate substratum of sentiency), by the grace of the singer of this celestial song, *Bhagavad Gita*.

May the selfless effort of Swāmī Nirguṇānanda Giriṇi in penning his thoughts for the benefit of the seekers be blessed by the Eternal Teacher, Lord Shri Krishna.

मङ्गलम् सर्वम्

maṅgalam sarvam

Swāmī Swānanda Tīrtha

Acharya, Shree Kailash Ashram,
Rishikesh - Himalayas

Introduction

Life presents each of us with unique challenges and trials. On the battlefield of *Kurukshetra*, when Arjuna faced one of the greatest moral and existential crises, Lord Krishna imparted to his anguished disciple the sacred teaching of discovering the spiritual within the mundane — delivered in ways both succinct and practical. These sublime teachings, the very essence of the Upanishads, were passed down to us by Sage Vyasa in the form of the *Srimad Bhagavad Gita*, the Divine Song.

Your circumstances may differ from those of Arjuna; your challenges may be varied, and your path may be uncertain. Yet the universal teachings of the *Gita* offer every seeker of truth a model for self-improvement and spiritual growth. The *Srimad Bhagavad Gita* is not meant solely for dedicated spiritual aspirants — it also serves as a practical handbook for everyday life. Anyone seeking to balance work and family responsibilities, maintain mental peace, and attain freedom from stress will find its teachings invaluable.

This workbook-style journal is not intended to impart the teachings of the *Gita* or to offer commentary — many revered *gurus* and scholars have already done so with great depth. Instead, *Gita Mananam* is designed to help you contemplate the *Gita*'s teachings and integrate them into your daily life.

Rooted in the Upanishadic spirit of the *Gita*, the journal honours the traditional practice of *Mananam*—the reflective assimilation of what has already been heard (*śravaṇam*) or studied (*adhyayanam*).

This journal invites you to explore the wisdom of the *Gita*, deepen your understanding, and apply its timeless insights to your personal and spiritual journey. The reflective questions accompanying selected *ślokas* are crafted to help you uncover personal meaning within the teachings, fostering greater clarity amid life's circumstances.

Just as Lord Krishna inspired Arjuna to engage in his righteous battle, may the Lord inspire you through this work to navigate your own daily duties with courage and discernment. The eternal purpose of the *Srimad Bhagavad Gita*, the celestial song, is to help you find inner peace and personal growth while remaining anchored in the Divine—even as you fulfil your worldly responsibilities.

I am grateful to Raghupathi Sringeri and Sheshagiri K M for the artwork used in this book. Several students from my *Gita* class dedicated themselves to proofreading, editing, translating, designing, and overseeing the printing process. I invoke the Lord's blessings for their selfless service, offered for the benefit of all readers.

Swāmī Nirguṇānanda Giri

Rishikesh, Bharat

How to use the Book

Since this is not a typical *Gita* study book, the following approach will help maximise its benefits:

Sequential Reading of ślokas — This book provides all the *Gita ślokas* (verses) along with their meanings. Read through the verses in the given order before engaging with the *Mananam* (Contemplation) and inspiration sections.

Contextual Understanding — While the *Mananam* questions focus on specific ślokas, it is beneficial to read the preceding verses to grasp the broader context.

Background in *Gita śravaṇam* — Ideally, one should have studied the *Gita* through structured exposition by a traditional *Vedānta* teacher (*śravaṇam*). However, such *śravaṇam* and prior formal study is not mandatory for using this book.

Deep Reflection on *Mananam* Questions — After reading the ślokas, engage with the *Mananam* questions thoughtfully. Read them multiple times, contemplating how they apply to your life and how their wisdom can be practiced or implemented.

Writing and Revisiting — Ponder upon the questions, and if necessary, revisit the *ślokas*. Make notes in the space provided in the book or in a separate notebook, recording insights and reflections.

Cultivating *Jijnāsu* — If additional questions arise during contemplation, write them down as well. This enquiry (*jijnāsu*) will naturally fuel the quest for deeper understanding.

Gaining Perspective — Conclude by reading the inspiration notes. Compare them with your interpretations—do they align with your insights or offer new perspectives?

Informal Contemplation — Beyond structured study, integrate contemplation into daily life. Select *Mananam* questions that resonate with you, and reflect on them during free moments throughout the day.

Prioritising Depth Over Quantity — The impact of this book lies not in how much is read, but in the quality and depth of contemplation. If you read for five minutes, dedicate at least 10–15 minutes to formal contemplation, allowing the teachings to permeate your thoughts informally throughout the day.

Living the Teachings — Let the fragrance of the *Gita* infuse every aspect of your life, enriching your interactions and radiating wisdom to those around you.

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Chapter 7

Jñāna Vijnāna Yoga

(Yoga of Wisdom and Practice)



श्रीभगवानुवाच —

मय्यासक्तमनाः पार्थ योगं युञ्जन्मदाश्रयः ।

असंशयं समग्रं मां यथा ज्ञास्यसि तच्छृणु ॥ ७.१ ॥

śrībhagavān uvāca —

mayyāsaktamanāḥ pārtha yōgaṁ yuñjanmadāśrayaḥ ।

asaṁśayaṁ samagraṁ māṁ yathā jñāsyasi tacchṛṇu ॥ 7.1 ॥

Sri Bhagavan said: O Arjuna, centre your mind upon Me, seek refuge in Me, and engage in the discipline of *yoga*. In this way, you shall come to know Me completely, without any doubt. Now, hear how this knowledge unfolds.

ज्ञानं तेऽहं सविज्ञानमिदं वक्ष्याम्यशेषतः ।

यज्ज्ञात्वा नेह भूयोऽन्यज्ज्ञातव्यमवशिष्यते ॥ ७.२ ॥

jñānaṁ tē:'haṁ savijñānamidaṁ vakṣyāmyaśēṣataḥ ।

yajjñātvā nēha bhūyō:'nyajjñātavyamavaśiṣyatē ॥ 7.2 ॥

I shall now impart to you complete knowledge together with practical wisdom (realisation). When you grasp this fully, nothing else in this world will remain for you to know.

Mananam Śloka - 2

Am I inclined to seek spiritual knowledge without applying it in practice? As in other areas of life, what distinguishes theoretical knowledge from practical understanding in spiritual life? How can my spiritual insights translate into wisdom and personal realisation, making them applicable in everyday life?

** Self Reflection****Inspiration**

In every aspect of life, there is a distinction between theoretical and practical knowledge. While spiritual knowledge can have general applications, the way each individual applies it in his or her own life will vary. However, there is a key difference in spiritual knowledge: unlike other fields where the accumulation of knowledge is limitless, spiritual knowledge has an endpoint. *Brahma Vidyā* is described as that knowledge by which all other knowledge becomes known—knowing One leads to knowing all!

मनुष्याणां सहस्रेषु कश्चिद्यतति सिद्धये ।

यततामपि सिद्धानां कश्चिन्मां वेत्ति तत्त्वतः ॥ ७.३ ॥

manuṣyāṇāṁ sahasrēṣu kaścidyatati siddhayē ।
yatatāmapi siddhānāṁ kaścinnmāṁ vētti tattvataḥ ॥ 7.3 ॥

Among thousands of people, only a few strive for perfection. And even among those rare ones who reach perfection, only one in thousands truly perceives My essence.

भूमिरापोऽनलो वायुः खं मनो बुद्धिरेव च ।

अहङ्कार इतीयं मे भिन्ना प्रकृतिरष्टधा ॥ ७.४ ॥

bhūmirāpō:'nalō vāyuḥ khaṁ manō buddhirēva ca ।
ahaṅkāra itīyaṁ mē bhinnā prakṛtirasṭadhā ॥ 7.4 ॥

Earth, water, fire, air, space, mind, intellect, and ego—these eight constitute My separated material energies.

अपरेयमितस्त्वन्यां प्रकृतिं विद्धि मे पराम् ।

जीवभूतां महाबाहो ययेदं धार्यते जगत् ॥ ७.५ ॥

aparēyamitastvanyāṁ prakṛtiṁ viddhi mē parām ।
jīvabhūtāṁ mahābāhō yayēdaṁ dhāryatē jagat ॥ 7.5 ॥

O mighty-armed Arjuna, beyond this lower *prakṛti*, know that there exists a higher *prakṛti* of Mine. It is the source of all living beings, and through it the entire universe is upheld.

एतद्योनीनि भूतानि सर्वाणीत्युपधारय ।

अहं कृत्स्नस्य जगतः प्रभवः प्रलयस्तथा ॥ ७.६ ॥

ētadyōnīni bhūtāni sarvāṇītyupadhāraya ।
ahaṁ kṛtsnasya jagataḥ prabhavaḥ pralayastathā ॥ 7.6 ॥

Know that all beings arise from these two *prakṛtis*' wombs. I am the origin of the entire universe, and I am also its dissolution.

Mananam Śloka – 3

Can I observe in my own society and surroundings that many people are focused on pursuing material goals? Can I see that others are primarily engaged in achieving personal success in their respective fields? Why is it that so few pursue genuine self-development and spiritual growth? Even among those who seek to discover their true Self or connect with the Divine, why do so few manage to persevere to the end? In my own life, what are the obstacles preventing me from choosing the higher path to lasting happiness?

Self Reflection

Inspiration

One of the *Upaniṣads* teaches that all human beings have a choice in their life's path. Some choose the path that pleases the senses and feeds the ego—this is the path of *preyas*. Others commit to the path of the higher good, which leads to ultimate happiness—this is the path of *śreyas*. Although many people are aware of these paths, very few choose to walk the latter. And even among those who do, only a few persist. This is where the guidance of the scriptures, *gurus*, and the support of the right companions become essential for a seeker (*sādhaka*). They are your most loyal cheerleaders!

Mananam Śloka - 4, 5

What are the various forces in nature that we experience? From a scientific perspective, we categorise them as matter, energy, and even mind. Are these forces in nature independent, or are they interdependent? Could there be another force distinct from these, yet sustaining them both? Can I directly observe the workings of these different forces in nature without relying on concepts from science or religion?

Self Reflection**Inspiration**

The *Gita* is pointing to us that *para* and *apara prakṛti* are the two forces at work in nature. While the functions of mind and matter are evident to all, the role of Consciousness, which supports and holds all matter together, remains a profound mystery that humans are meant to unravel. As long as we are content with a life identified with matter, or at most, with the mind, our true identity will remain hidden from us. A *jijñāsu* is someone who sincerely desires to know this deeper reality, while a *mumukṣu* is one who is determined to pursue it at any cost.

मत्तः परतरं नान्यत्किञ्चिदस्ति धनञ्जय ।

मयि सर्वमिदं प्रोतं सूत्रे मणिगणा इव ॥ ७.७ ॥

mattaḥ parataraṁ nānyatkiñcidasti dhanañjaya ।
mayi sarvamidaṁ prōtaṁ sūtrē maṇigaṇā iva ॥ 7.7 ॥

O Dhananjaya (the winner of wealth, Arjuna), there is nothing higher than Me. All that exists in the universe is woven into Me, as pearls are strung upon a thread.

रसोऽहमप्सु कौन्तेय प्रभास्मि शशिसूर्ययोः ।

प्रणवः सर्ववेदेषु शब्दः खे पौरुषं नृषु ॥ ७.८ ॥

raso:'hamapsu kauntēya prabhāsmi śaśisūryayōḥ ।
praṇavaḥ sarvavēdēṣu śabdaḥ khē pauruṣaṁ nṛṣu ॥ 7.8 ॥

O Kaunteya, I am the very essence of water, the radiance of the sun and the moon, the sacred syllable *Om* in all the Vedas, the sound that pervades space, and the essential strength found in human beings.

पुण्यो गन्धः पृथिव्यां च तेजश्चास्मि विभावसौ ।

जीवनं सर्वभूतेषु तपश्चास्मि तपस्विषु ॥ ७.९ ॥

puṇyō gandhaḥ pṛthivyāṁ ca tējaścāsmi vibhāvasau ।
jīvanaṁ sarvabhūteṣu tapaścāsmi tapasviṣu ॥ 7.9 ॥

I am the pure fragrance of the earth, the brilliance within fire, the life force that dwells in all beings, and the austerity of those who practise penance.

बीजं मां सर्वभूतानां विद्धि पार्थ सनातनम् ।

बुद्धिर्बुद्धिमतामस्मि तेजस्तेजस्विनामहम् ॥ ७.१० ॥

bījaṁ māṁ sarvabhūtānāṁ viddhi pārtha sanātanam ।
buddhirbuddhimatāmasmi tējastējasvināmaham ॥ 7.10 ॥

O Partha, know that I am the eternal seed of all beings. I am the wisdom that shines in the wise, and the radiance that illumines the radiant.

Mananam Śloka - 7

What do I understand to be the supreme force that governs all other forces of nature? How do I conceive of this essential energy that sustains everything, serving as the foundation of all creation? What insights do the scriptures provide about this? Where and how can I see, know, or comprehend it? How can I perceive the workings of this central force within my own body and mind? Which spiritual practices might help me directly experience it?

Self Reflection***Inspiration***

A necklace of pearls is held together by a thread, yet our attention is drawn to the beads, not the thread itself. Similarly, the Lord is the unseen force, the source of all other forces at work in the universe. For the spiritually aware, this Divine Energy is the essence of everything, though unseen—just as gravity is constantly at work, yet never directly perceived.

Mananam Śloka - 10

What is it within the tiny seed that allows it to grow into a giant tree? What gives the brain its ability to generate thought and expression? What illuminates the sunlight and the light of the stars? What infuses beauty into some of the most magnificent wonders of nature? Have I lost the curiosity and wonder of a child? Is there value in looking at nature with awe? Could such admiration lead me to discover the One Divine hiding behind it all?

Self Reflection***Inspiration***

The beauty and complexity of creation cannot be a mere accident. The force that holds the planets and stars in place, that governs our digestion and respiration, must be the most noble presence in all of existence. If this presence were to demand payment for its services, we might be enslaved for eternity. Yet, the Lord serves us without expecting anything in return. Can we not at least express our gratitude for such unconditional love?

बलं बलवतां चाहं कामरागविवर्जितम् ।

धर्माविरुद्धो भूतेषु कामोऽस्मि भरतर्षभ ॥ ७.११ ॥

balam balavatām cāhaṁ kāmārāgavivarjitaṁ ।

dharmāviruddhō bhūteṣu kāmō:'smi bharatarṣabha ॥ 7.11 ॥

I am the strength of the strong, free from desire and attachment.
And I am the desire that dwells in all beings, when it is in harmony
with *dharma*, O *Bharatarṣabha* (the best of the Bharata family).

ये चैव सात्त्विका भावा राजसास्तमसाश्च ये ।

मत्त एवेति तान्विद्धि न त्वहं तेषु ते मयि ॥ ७.१२ ॥

yē caiva sātत्वikā bhāvā rājasāstamasāśca yē ।

matta ēvēti tānviddhi na tvaḥaṁ teṣu tē mayi ॥ 7.12 ॥

All beings and objects that embody the qualities of *sattva* (goodness), *rajas* (passion), and *tamas* (ignorance)—know that these arise from Me. Yet I am not contained within them; rather, they abide in Me.

त्रिभिर्गुणमयैर्भावैरेभिः सर्वमिदं जगत् ।

मोहितं नाभिजानाति मामेभ्यः परमव्ययम् ॥ ७.१३ ॥

tribhirguṇamayairbhāvairēbhiḥ sarvamidaṁ jagat ।

mōhitaṁ nābhijānāti māmēbhyaḥ paramavyayam ॥ 7.13 ॥

The entire world is deluded by the states of three *guṇas*—*sattva*, *rajas*, and *tamas*, and thereby do not realise Me, the imperishable reality, who stands beyond these qualities.

दैवी ह्येषा गुणमयी मम माया दुरत्यया ।

मामेव ये प्रपद्यन्ते मायामेतां तरन्ति ते ॥ ७.१४ ॥

daivī hyēṣā guṇamayī mama māyā duratyayā ।

māmēva yē prapadyantē māyāmētāṁ taranti tē ॥ 7.14 ॥

Truly, this divine *māyā* of Mine, woven from the three *guṇas*, is exceedingly difficult to overcome. Yet those who surrender unto Me cross beyond this *māyā*.

Mananam Śloka - 14

What is the nature of delusion? Could it be that we are all caught in a mass illusion, as the Hindu scriptures suggest? What are some of the actions that I have done in my life while in a deluded state of mind, only to regret later? What helps me return to a state of awareness? What habits do I still indulge in that may stem from a deluded mind? How can I avoid falling into such traps again? Is there any external guidance or support that can help me break free from these states?

Self Reflection**Inspiration:**

Māyā is one of the most profound concepts across world philosophies, describing the force that disconnects us from our true nature and the Divine. Modern examples like movies and virtual reality provide a tangible way to grasp the idea of *māyā*. Just as a magician manipulates and controls a magic show, there is a divine magician who governs the illusive power of *māyā*. The purpose of the magician is not based on some cruel or manipulative intent. Those who seek refuge in Him are lifted into reality, where the illusions and nightmares end forever.

न मां दुष्कृतिनो मूढाः प्रपद्यन्ते नराधमाः ।

माययापहतज्ञाना आसुरं भावमाश्रिताः ॥ ७.१५ ॥

na mām duṣkṛtinō mūḍhāḥ prapadyantē narādhmāḥ ।
māyayāpahṛtajñānā āsuram bhāvamāśritāḥ ॥ 7.15 ॥

The wicked, the deluded, and the lowest among men do not turn to Me. Those whose understanding is clouded by illusion (*māyā*), and who embrace demonic ways, likewise do not surrender to Me.

चतुर्विधा भजन्ते मां जनाः सुकृतिनोऽर्जुन ।

आर्तो जिज्ञासुरर्थार्थी ज्ञानी च भरतर्षभ ॥ ७.१६ ॥

caturvidhā bhajantē mām janāḥ sukr̥tinō'rjuna ।
ārtō jijñāsurarthaṛthī jñānī ca bharatarṣabha ॥ 7.16 ॥

O *Bharatarṣabha* (Arjuna), four kinds of virtuous ones worship Me: those who are distressed, those seeking knowledge, those desiring worldly gains, and those endowed with wisdom.

तेषां ज्ञानी नित्ययुक्त एकभक्तिर्विशिष्यते ।

प्रियो हि ज्ञानिनोऽत्यर्थमहं स च मम प्रियः ॥ ७.१७ ॥

tēṣām jñānī nityayukta ēkabhaktirviśiṣyatē ।
priyō hi jñāninō'tyarthamaham sa ca mama priyaḥ ॥ 7.17 ॥

Among them, the wise devotee—ever steadfast and single-minded in devotion to Me—is the most distinguished. To them I am most beloved, and they are most beloved to Me.

उदाराः सर्व एवैते ज्ञानी त्वात्मैव मे मतम् ।

आस्थितः स हि युक्तात्मा मामेवानुत्तमां गतिम् ॥ ७.१८ ॥

udārāḥ sarva ēvaitē jñānī tvātmaiva mē matam । āsthitaḥ sa hi
yuktātmā māmēvānuttamām gatim ॥ 7.18 ॥

Indeed, all these seekers are noble. Yet the wise are regarded as My very Self. Such a person, steadfast in mind, is devoted solely to the supreme goal that is in Me.

Mananam Śloka - 15

What has inspired me to pursue the higher truth? What life experiences have guided me towards seeking God? Can I find gratitude in my past suffering or loss, or in moments of grace or guidance from revered ones, for leading me to the spiritual path? How can I maintain the wisdom to avoid falling back into a state of delusion where I neglect seeking the truth or honouring the Divine?

 Self Reflection**Inspiration**

Many people in this world are content without ever seeking spiritual practices or the truth of a higher being. These individuals, known as '*pāmara*', are driven solely by sensual desires. They lack insight into higher realities and have no inclination to seek them. Their focus is entirely on finding happiness in the material world. However, deep within their hearts, there resides an unconscious fear of death and the afterlife, which continually nags at them.

Mananam Śloka - 16

Where am I in my journey towards God or Truth? What is my main motivation? Do I only pray to a higher power when I am in distress or need? Do I seek blessings from the great ones for worldly success and protection? Do I have a strong desire to know the Divine or the utmost essence of my own Being? Do I feel reverence or devotion towards those who impart higher wisdom? How can I purify my devotion to God and deepen my understanding of the ultimate Truth?

 Self Reflection***Inspiration***

Even among those who seek God, motivations can differ greatly. Initially, many seekers are driven by the desire to alleviate some form of suffering and attain worldly happiness. Some undertake spiritual practices to gain a competitive edge over others. Eventually, a genuine interest in understanding oneself and the greater force that sustains all creation may develop. With proper guidance, such seekers acquire the right wisdom, which further refines their motivation on the spiritual path. Our goals and desires in life are all based on our level of understanding.

बहूनां जन्मनामन्ते ज्ञानवान्मां प्रपद्यते ।

वासुदेवः सर्वमिति स महात्मा सुदुर्लभः ॥ ७.१९ ॥

bahūnām janmanāmantē jñānavānmām prapadyatē ।
vāsudēvaḥ sarvamiti sa mahātmā sudurlabhaḥ ॥ 7.19 ॥

After many births, the wise one takes refuge in Me. Realising that *Vāsudeva* is all, such a great soul is exceedingly rare.

कामैस्तैस्तैर्हृतज्ञानाः प्रपद्यन्तेऽन्यदेवताः ।

तं तं नियममास्थाय प्रकृत्या नियताः स्वया ॥ ७.२० ॥

kāmaistaistairhṛtajñānāḥ prapadyantē:'nyadēvatāḥ ।
taṁ taṁ niyamamāsthāya prakṛtyā niyatāḥ svayā ॥ 7.20 ॥

Driven by one or other desires, people turn to various deities. They follow one or the other practices, as dictated by their tendencies.

यो यो यां यां तनुं भक्तः श्रद्धयार्चितुमिच्छति ।

तस्य तस्याचलां श्रद्धां तामेव विदधाम्यहम् ॥ ७.२१ ॥

yō yō yām yām tanuṁ bhaktaḥ śraddhayārcitumicchati ।
tasya tasyācalāṁ śraddhāṁ tāmēva vidadhāmyaham ॥ 7.21 ॥

Whatever form of deity devotees seek to worship with faith, I make that faith steady and unwavering in them.

स तया श्रद्धया युक्तस्तस्या राधनमीहते ।

लभते च ततः कामान्मयैव विहितान्हि तान् ॥ ७.२२ ॥

sa tayā śraddhayā yuktastasyā rāadhanamīhatē ।
labhatē ca tataḥ kāmānmayaiva vihitānhi tān ॥ 7.22 ॥

Endowed with that faith, the devotees seek the deity of their choice. From that deity they obtain their desired objects, though it is I alone who grant them those fruits.

Mananam Śloka 18, 19

How can I enhance my wisdom and gain realisation on the spiritual path? Why is it important to maintain balance between devotion and concentration while also advancing in knowledge? What makes the path of knowledge (*jñāna-yoga*) unique? Why does the Lord extol those on this path to be the dearest and closest to Divine? What is the vision and outlook of a spiritually wise person toward which I can aspire?

** Self Reflection*****Inspiration***

The pinnacle of wisdom is realising oneness with the Divine and perceiving that Divinity in everything. Only then can all seeking come to an end. All other forms of worldly wisdom and the forces that sustain it will still uphold a dualistic vision. Where there is duality, the suffering of *saṁsāra* will persist. Such wisdom is attained only when one refuses to compromise with lesser truths and their rewards.

Mananam Śloka - 21

What is the nature of my faith? Is it merely a feeling, a sense of loyalty, or blind faith? How did I decide to follow this path? Have I reflected deeply enough on it? Do I observe any progress or positive changes in myself and in my daily life? Does my intellectual understanding align with my intuitive sense? Does this path offer a vision of the supreme truth and the means to attain it? Or, does it require me to become one-sided and look down on other paths and means?

Self Reflection**Inspiration**

As one's understanding deepens, so do one's aspirations, both in worldly and spiritual life. With deep commitment to any path, our faith intensifies. Consequently, there are various '*darśanas*' (views or philosophies) even among those who follow the same scriptures, each claiming to hold the ultimate truth. This verse cautions us against placing our faith in the wrong people and means without proper study and discernment. While being faithful to one's path is commendable, it is problematic if the path is rigid and dismissive of others. In such cases, we must reconsider our approach.

अन्तवत्तु फलं तेषां तद्भवत्यल्पमेधसाम् ।

देवान्देवयजो यान्ति मद्भक्ता यान्ति मामपि ॥ ७.२३ ॥

antavattu phalaṁ tēṣāṁ tadbhavatyalpamēdhasām ।

dēvāndēvayajō yānti madbhaktā yānti māmapi ॥ 7.23 ॥

But the results gained by such people of limited understanding is fleeting. Those who worship other deities go to those deities. Yet those who worship Me come (directly) to Me alone.

अव्यक्तं व्यक्तिमापन्नं मन्यन्ते मामबुद्धयः ।

परं भावमजानन्तो ममाव्ययमनुत्तमम् ॥ ७.२४ ॥

avyaktaṁ vyaktimāpannaṁ manyantē māmabuddhayaḥ । paraṁ
bhāvamajānāntō mamāvyayamanuttamam ॥ 7.24 ॥

Those without wisdom think of Me, the unmanifest, as having assumed manifestation. They do not know My supreme, imperishable, and unsurpassed nature.

नाहं प्रकाशः सर्वस्य योगमायासमावृतः ।

मूढोऽयं नाभिजानाति लोको मामजमव्ययम् ॥ ७.२५ ॥

nāhaṁ prakāśaḥ sarvasya yōgamāyāsamāvṛtaḥ ।

mūḍhō:'yaṁ nābhijānāti lōkō māmajamavyayam ॥ 7.25 ॥

I am not manifest to all, being veiled by My divine illusive power (*yoga-māyā*). This deluded world does not know Me, the unborn and imperishable.

वेदाहं समतीतानि वर्तमानानि चार्जुन ।

भविष्याणि च भूतानि मां तु वेद न कश्चन ॥ ७.२६ ॥

vēdāhaṁ samatītāni vartamānāni cārjuna ।

bhaviṣyāṇi ca bhūtāni mām tu vēda na kaścana ॥ 7.26 ॥

O Arjuna, I know all beings—past, present, and future. Yet none truly knows Me (in My entirety).

Mananam Śloka - 23

To which forms of gods or deities do I pray? What outcomes or rewards do I seek from these practices? Are the promised results of my practices finite and time-bound? Is my devotion directed towards lesser gods or to the Supreme? Do I have a sufficient understanding of the Supreme Being, the Self, and the ultimate Truth?

** Self Reflection*****Inspiration***

Regardless of the nature of our practices, we should aspire to realize the Supreme Being, which is the ultimate reality of our own existence. All other forms of worship and practices will only provide short-term rewards. True wisdom, acquired through a lineage of *gurus* and the scriptures, ensures that we remain on the right path and that our efforts will not be diverted from the supreme goal of life.

इच्छाद्वेषसमुत्थेन द्वन्द्वमोहेन भारत ।

सर्वभूतानि संमोहं सर्गे यान्ति परन्तप ॥ ७.२७ ॥

icchādvēṣasamutthēna dvandvamōhēna bhārata ।
sarvabhūtāni saṁmōhaṁ sargē yānti parantapa ॥ 7.27 ॥

O Bhārata, O Parantapa (Arjuna), all beings are deluded at birth
by the dualities of desire and aversion, arising from delusion.

येषां त्वन्तगतं पापं जनानां पुण्यकर्मणाम् ।

ते द्वन्द्वमोहनिर्मुक्ता भजन्ते मां दृढव्रताः ॥ ७.२८ ॥

yēṣāṁ tvantagataṁ pāpaṁ janānāṁ puṇyakarmaṇām ।
tē dvandvamōhanirmuktā bhajantē mām dṛḍhavrataḥ ॥ 7.28 ॥

Freed from sin, purified by righteous action, and freed from
the delusion of dualities, such steadfast ones worship Me with
steadfast vows.

जरामरणमोक्षाय मामाश्रित्य यतन्ति ये ।

ते ब्रह्म तद्विदुः कृत्स्नमध्यात्मं कर्म चाखिलम् ॥ ७.२९ ॥

jarāmaraṇamōkṣāya māmāśritya yatanti yē ।
tē brahma tadviduḥ kṛtsnamadhyātmaṁ karma cākḥilam ॥ 7.29 ॥

Those who strive for liberation from old age and death, taking
refuge in Me, they know *Brahman*, the Self, and all action in its
entirety.

साधिभूताधिदैवं मां साधियज्ञं च ये विदुः ।

प्रयाणकालेऽपि च मां ते विदुर्युक्तचेतसः ॥ ७.३० ॥

sādhibhūtādhidaivaṁ mām sādhiyajñaṁ ca yē viduḥ ।
prayāṇakālē'pi ca mām tē viduryuktacētasah ॥ 7.30 ॥

Those who know Me along with the knowledge of the material
elements (*ādhibhūta*), the divine beings (*ādhidaiva*), and
sacrifice (*ādhiyajña*)—such steadfast ones know Me even at the
time of death.

Mananam Śloka - 29

Who and what are my sources of support in the world? In which areas can I rely on my family, friends, and others for support? In which areas might I not be able to rely on them? Under what conditions are worldly sources of refuge inadequate or limited? What concept can I envision for a refuge that transcends these limitations? How can such an Infinite Being be the ultimate assurance, enhancing my sense of self?

Self Reflection***Inspiration***

In many aspects of material life, we can rely on support from people, society, and the government. However, when facing the inevitability of old age and death, our highest refuge is God alone. Regardless of how much we rationalise, the mind needs something to hold onto. For a practitioner, the form of God or a felt presence of the Divine provides that support. For one who is stabilised in wisdom, the realisation of the Self and its unbroken connection with the Infinite serves as that anchor.

ॐ तत्सदिति श्रीमद्भगवद्गीतासूपनिषत्सु ब्रह्मविद्यायां योगशास्त्रे
श्रीकृष्णार्जुनसंवादे ज्ञानविज्ञानयोगो नाम सप्तमोऽध्यायः ॥

ōṃ tatsaditi śrīmadbhagavadgītās ūpaniṣatsu
brahmavidyāyāṃ yōgaśāstrē
śrīkṛṣṇārjunasaṃvādē jñānavijñānayōgō
nāma prathamodhyāyaḥ ॥



Chapter 8

Akṣhara Brahma Yoga

(The Yoga of the Eternal God)



अर्जुन उवाच —

किं तद्ब्रह्म किमध्यात्मं किं कर्म पुरुषोत्तम ।

अधिभूतं च किं प्रोक्तमधिदैवं किमुच्यते ॥ ८.१ ॥

arjuna uvāca —

kiṁ tadbrahma kimadhyātmam kiṁ karma puruṣōttama ।
adhibhūtam ca kiṁ prōktamadhidaivam kimucyate ॥ 8.1 ॥

Arjuna said: O *Puruṣottama* (Supreme being, Krishna), what is *Brahman*, what is the Self (*adhyātmā*), and what is action? What is described as the material principle (*adhibhūtam*), and what is known as the divine principle (*adhidaivam*)?

अधियज्ञः कथं कोऽत्र देहेऽस्मिन्मधुसूदन ।

प्रयाणकाले च कथं ज्ञेयोऽसि नियतात्मभिः ॥ ८.२ ॥

adhiyajñaḥ katham kō'tra dēhē'sminmadhusūdana ।
prayāṇakālē ca katham jñēyō'si niyatātmabhiḥ ॥ 8.2 ॥

O Madhusūdana (Destroyer of Madhu, Krishna), who is the presiding principle of sacrifice (*adhiyajña*) here in this body, and how are You to be known at the time of death by the self-controlled?

Mananam Śloka - 1, 2

Have I ever delved into inquiries about the nature of the universe, its origin, and the forces that sustain it? Or have my curiosities been quenched by the answers handed down to me, leading me to now consider such inquiries impractical and a waste of time?

What about inquiries into the nature of life? Do I still aspire to find deeper meaning and purpose in life? What are my notions and beliefs about the afterlife and reincarnation?

Self Reflection***Inspiration***

The starting point for all discoveries comes from asking the right questions, whether in the field of science or spirituality. Engaging in inquiries and probing deeper is also the art of contemplation that philosophers and sages have practiced. The Buddha's quest for truth began with an inquiry into the general nature of suffering. Ramana Maharshi's realization came about through the inquiry 'Who am I?'

The value of studying the scriptures is not to find a set of ready answers, but to learn how to ask the right questions that lead to personal realization. We must keep the lamp of inquiry aflame with the urgency of finding answers in this very life!

श्रीभगवानुवाच —

अक्षरं ब्रह्म परमं स्वभावोऽध्यात्ममुच्यते ।

भूतभावोद्भवकरो विसर्गः कर्मसंज्ञितः ॥ ८.३ ॥

śrībhagavān uvāca —

akṣaram brahma paramaṁ svabhāvō:'dhyātma-mucyate |
bhūtabhāvōdbhava-karō visargaḥ karmasaṁjñitaḥ || 8.3 ||

Sri Bhagavan said: The imperishable *Brahman* is supreme. The essential nature of a being is called the Self. The creative force that brings beings into existence is known as *karma*.

अधिभूतं क्षरो भावः पुरुषश्चाधिदैवतम् ।

अधियज्ञोऽहमेवात्र देहे देहभृतां वर ॥ ८.४ ॥

adhibhūtaṁ kṣarō bhāvaḥ puruṣaścādhidaivatam |
adhiyajñō:'hamēvātra dēhē dēhabhṛtāṁ vara || 8.4 ||

The material principle (*adhibhūta*) is My perishable nature; the divine principle (*adhidaiva*) is the *Puruṣa* (Conscious being or Consciousness from *Sāṅkhya* philosophy). And I alone am the *adhiyajña* here in the body, O best of embodied beings (Arjuna).

अन्तकाले च मामेव स्मरन्मुक्त्वा कलेवरम् ।

यः प्रयाति स मद्भावं याति नास्त्यत्र संशयः ॥ ८.५ ॥

antakālē ca māmēva smaranmuktva kalēbaram |
yaḥ prayāti sa madbhāvaṁ yāti nāstyatra saṁśayaḥ || 8.5 ||

Whoever, at the final moment, remembers Me alone and leaves the body, attains My state of being, without doubt.

यं यं वापि स्मरन्भावं त्यजत्यन्ते कलेवरम् ।

तं तमेवैति कौन्तेय सदा तद्भावंभावितः ॥ ८.६ ॥

yaṁ yaṁ vāpi smaranbhāvaṁ tyajatyantē kalēbaram |
taṁ tamēvaiti kauntēya sadā tadbhāva-bhāvitaḥ || 8.6 ||

At the final moment, whatever thought or state one remembers, that he attains, O Arjuna, being shaped by constant absorption in it.

Mananam Śloka – 5, 6

Have I ever considered the importance of the state of mind at the moment of death? Or am I solely focused on enjoying life and having pleasurable experiences daily? Have I experienced the connection between the nature of my thoughts prior to sleep and how they influence my dreams?

How can I ensure that my thoughts at the moment of leaving my body are centred on God or the Divinity within me? During difficult moments in my life, do my thoughts turn to God?

Self Reflection**Inspiration**

All our thoughts and efforts leave imprints in the unseen areas of the mind. These imprints deeply influence all our activities. The scriptures assert that our next life (rebirth in any realm) is determined by the most dominant and reaffirmed impressions. In fact, other scriptures point out that not just rebirth but liberation can be attained at the crucial moment of transition from this body. If our thoughts at the time of death can hold onto that One Divine essence, it is the most effective approach to liberation. However, we can only contemplate any one given desired thing at the point of death if we have practiced it throughout our life. Thus, for a *sādhaka*, all life is an opportunity to practice being in the Divine presence.

तस्मात्सर्वेषु कालेषु मामनुस्मर युध्य च ।

मय्यर्पितमनोबुद्धिर्मा मेवैष्यस्यसंशयः ॥ ८.७ ॥

tasmātsarvēṣu kālēṣu māmanusmara yudhya ca ।
mayyarpitamanoḥbuddhirāmāvēṣyasasyasaṁśayaḥ ॥ 8.7 ॥

Therefore, at all times remember Me and fight (perform your duty). With mind and intellect offered to Me, you shall surely come to Me, without doubt.

अभ्यासयोगयुक्तेन चेतसा नान्यगामिना ।

परमं पुरुषं दिव्यं याति पार्थानुचिन्तयन् ॥ ८.८ ॥

abhyāsayōgayuktēna cētasā nānyagāminā ।
paramaṁ puruṣaṁ divyaṁ yāti pārthānucintayan ॥ 8.8 ॥

With the mind disciplined by the regular practice of *yoga*, not distracted elsewhere, one attains the supreme, divine *Puruṣa* by constantly meditating upon Him, O Pārtha (Arjuna).

कविं पुराणमनुशासितारमणोरणीयांसमनुस्मरेद्यः ।

सर्वस्य धातारमचिन्त्यरूपमादित्यवर्णं तमसः परस्तात् ॥ ८.९ ॥

kaviṁ purāṇamanuśāsītāramaṇōraṇīyāṁsamanusmarēdyaḥ ।
sarvasya dhātāramacintyarūpamādityavarṇaṁ
tamaśaḥ parastāt ॥ 8.9 ॥

He who meditates upon the omniscient, primeval ruler, subtler than the subtle, the sustainer of all, of inconceivable form, radiant like the sun, beyond all darkness...

प्रयाणकाले मनसाचलेन भक्त्या युक्तो योगबलेन चैव ।

भ्रुवोर्मध्ये प्राणमावेश्य सम्यक्स तं परं पुरुषमुपैति दिव्यम् ॥ ८.१० ॥

prayāṇakālē manasācalēna bhaktyā yuktō yōgabalēna caiva ।
bhruvōrmaḍhyē prāṇamāvēśya samya
ksa taṁ paraṁ puruṣamupaiti divyaṁ ॥ 8.10 ॥

At the time of departure, with mind unwavering, devotion steady, and by the power of *yoga*, fixing the life-breath between the eyebrows, one attains the supreme, divine *Puruṣa*.

यदक्षरं वेदविदो वदन्ति विशन्ति यद्यतयो वीतरागाः ।

यदिच्छन्तो ब्रह्मचर्यं चरन्ति तत्ते पदं सङ्गहेण प्रवक्ष्ये ॥ ८.११ ॥

yadakṣaraṁ vēdavidō vadanti viśanti yadyatayō vītarāgāḥ ।

yadicchantō brahmacaryaṁ caranti

tattē padaṁ saṅgrahēṇa pravakṣyē ॥ 8.11 ॥

That imperishable state, which the knowers of the *Veda* declare, into which the self-controlled and passionless ascetics enter, desiring which they practice celibacy—that state I shall briefly declare to you.

सर्वद्वाराणि संयम्य मनो हृदि निरुध्य च ।

मूर्ध्न्याधायात्मनः प्राणमास्थितो योगधारणाम् ॥ ८.१२ ॥

sarvadvārāṇi saṁyamya manō hṛdi nirudhya ca ।

mūrdhnyādhāyātmanāḥ prāṇamāsthito yōgadhāraṇām ॥ 8.12 ॥

Restraining all the gates of the body (senses), fixing the mind in the heart, and directing the life-breath to the crown of the head, one becomes firmly established in the practice of *yoga*.

ओमित्येकाक्षरं ब्रह्म व्याहरन्मामनुस्मरन् ।

यः प्रयाति त्यजन्देहं स याति परमां गतिम् ॥ ८.१३ ॥

ōmityēkāṣaraṁ brahma vyāharanmāmanusmaran ।

yaḥ prayāti tyajandēhaṁ sa yāti paramāṁ gatim ॥ 8.13 ॥

Uttering the single syllable *Om*, which is (the symbol of) *Brahman*, and remembering Me, whoever departs leaving the body attains the supreme goal.

अनन्यचेताः सततं यो मां स्मरति नित्यशः ।

तस्याहं सुलभः पार्थ नित्ययुक्तस्य योगिनः ॥ ८.१४ ॥

ananyacētāḥ satataṁ yō māṁ smarati nityaśaḥ ।

tasyāhaṁ sulabhaḥ pārtha nityayuktasya yōgināḥ ॥ 8.14 ॥

O Pārtha, I am easily attainable by the *yogi* who is ever united, who remembers Me constantly with single-minded devotion.

Mananam Śloka - 10, 13

Just as there are various medical sciences for physical and mental well-being, could there be a lesser-known science that reveals the path for the soul departing the physical body? Do my doubts and lack of trust about the afterlife and reincarnation deter me from undertaking any investigation on my own?

Have I practiced or undertaken any serious investigation to gain personal experience or understanding of whether there is a soul beyond this body-mind? Have I explored whether there is a supreme entity and its nature may be, which we conceptually refer to as “God”?

** Self Reflection*****Inspiration***

The Lord provides a specific technique to attain Him, as mere words may not suffice for most. This technique involves using the sacred syllable *OM*, stilling the mind, and focusing attention on the spiritual energy centre in the body, located between the eyebrows. To effectively use this technique at the point of death, one must practice it during life and verify its effectiveness. Just as a warrior who practices regularly is prepared for battle, so too must we prepare ourselves through consistent practice in life so that we are prepared to face death.

मामुपेत्य पुनर्जन्म दुःखालयमशाश्वतम् ।

नाप्नुवन्ति महात्मानः संसिद्धिं परमां गताः ॥ ८.१५ ॥

māmupētya punarjanma duḥkhālayamaśāśvatam ।

nāpnuvanti mahātmānaḥ saṁsiddhiṁ paramāṁ gatāḥ ॥ 8.15 ॥

Having attained Me, the great souls do not return to rebirth, which is the abode of sorrow, and impermanent. They have reached the supreme perfection.

आब्रह्मभुवनल्लोकाः पुनरावर्तिनोऽर्जुन ।

मामुपेत्य तु कौन्तेय पुनर्जन्म न विद्यते ॥ ८.१६ ॥

ā brahmabhuvanāllōkāḥ punarāvartinō:'rjuna ।

māmupētya tu kauntēya punarjanma na vidyatē ॥ 8.16 ॥

O Arjuna, all worlds—even up to Brahmā's abode—are subject to return. But those who attain Me never face rebirth again, O Kaunteya (son of Kunti, Arjuna).

सहस्रयुगपर्यन्तमहर्षद्वह्मणो विदुः ।

रात्रिं युगसहस्रान्तां तेऽहोरात्रविदो जनाः ॥ ८.१७ ॥

sahasrayugaparyantamaharyadbhrahmaṇō viduḥ ।

rātriṁ yugasahasrāntāṁ tē:'hōrātravidō janāḥ ॥ 8.17 ॥

Those who know day and night (cosmic time) understand that the day of Brahmā lasts for a thousand *yugas* (aeons), and his night also lasts for a thousand *yugas*.

अव्यक्ताद्यक्तयः सर्वाः प्रभवन्त्यहरागमे ।

रात्र्यागमे प्रलीयन्ते तत्रैवाव्यक्तसंज्ञके ॥ ८.१८ ॥

avyaktādyaktayaḥ sarvāḥ prabhavantyaharāgamē ।

rātryāgamē pralīyante tatraivāvyaktasamjñakē ॥ 8.18 ॥

From the unmanifest, all beings come forth at the arrival of day (of Brahmā); at the arrival of night, they dissolve into that same unmanifest.

भूतग्रामः स एवायं भूत्वा भूत्वा प्रलीयते ।

रात्र्यागमेऽवशः पार्थ प्रभवत्यहरागमे ॥ ८.१९ ॥

bhūtagrāmaḥ sa ēvāyaṁ bhūtvā bhūtvā pralīyatē ।

rātryāgamē:'vaśaḥ pārtha prabhavatyaharāgamē ॥ 8.19 ॥

O Pārtha (Arjuna), this multitude of beings repeatedly comes into existence and dissolves at Brahmā's night; helplessly, it arises again at the dawn of his day.

परस्तस्मात्तु भावोऽन्योऽव्यक्तोऽव्यक्तात्सनातनः ।

यः स सर्वेषु भूतेषु नश्यत्सु न विनश्यति ॥ ८.२० ॥

parastasmāttu bhāvō:'nyō:'vyaktō:'vyaktātsanātanah |
yaḥ sa sarvēṣu bhūtēṣu naśyatsu na vinaśyati || 8.20 ||

Yet beyond this unmanifest lies another, eternal unmanifest. Though all beings perish, that reality does not perish.

अव्यक्तोऽक्षर इत्युक्तस्तमाहुः परमां गतिम् ।

यं प्राप्य न निवर्तन्ते तद्धाम परमं मम ॥ ८.२१ ॥

avyaktō:'kṣara ityuktastamāhuḥ paramāṁ gatim |
yaṁ prāpya na nivartantē taddhāma paramaṁ mama || 8.21 ||

That unmanifest, imperishable reality is spoken of as the supreme goal. Having attained it, one never returns; it is My supreme abode.

पुरुषः स परः पार्थ भक्त्या लभ्यस्त्वनन्यया ।

यस्यान्तःस्थानि भूतानि येन सर्वमिदं ततम् ॥ ८.२२ ॥

puruṣaḥ sa paraḥ pārtha bhaktyā labhyaṣtvanyayā |
yasyāntaḥsthāni bhūtāni yēna sarvamidam tatam || 8.22 ||

O Pārtha (Arjuna), the Supreme Person is attained through unwavering devotion alone. All beings abide in Him, and He pervades the entire universe.

यत्र काले त्वनावृत्तिमावृत्तिं चैव योगिनः ।

प्रयाता यान्ति तं कालं वक्ष्यामि भरतर्षभ ॥ ८.२३ ॥

yatra kālē tvanāvṛttimāvṛttim caiva yōginah |
prayātā yānti taṁ kālaṁ vakṣyāmi bharatarṣabha || 8.23 ||

O Bharatarṣabha (best of the Bharatas), I will now explain the times of departure by which *yogis* attain liberation and by which they return again (are reborn).

Mananam Śloka – 20, 21

What is my understanding of the unmanifest (*Avyakta*), where the seed of all creation lies? Can there be a time when the world comes to an end? Every night, when I enter deep sleep, don't I experience the dissolution of my perception of this world? When I wake up in the morning, how does this world re-emerge for me? How am I able to recollect memories, regain self-awareness, and become aware of the world again? Was I present during deep sleep or not? Similarly, can the common experience of the world also undergo dissolution and re-emergence, as the Hindu scriptures suggest?

** Self Reflection****Inspiration**

One of the greatest wonders and mysteries of the world is how an entire tree emerges from a seed. Just as the design of a tree is contained within a seed, the imprint of the entire universe lies in the Unmanifest state before creation and dissolves back into that state at dissolution. The eternal Consciousness or Existence that remains beyond the unmanifest is the ultimate destination of all souls. Finding our path back to that reality leads us to the ultimate resting place. The entire science of *yoga* aims to guide us back to this essential reality, freeing us from the cycles of birth and death.

Mananam Śloka - 22

Why should I engage in inquiries about the unmanifest state and the Supreme beyond it? Can I not be content like the majority who follow the dogma, “Seeing is believing”?

How can understanding the unmanifest state and the Supreme help me know more about myself? Can the essential Source of all creation be present within this creation? What is the true power behind my abilities to see, hear, think, breathe, and digest? Is there one essential attribute common to all life, similar to how breath is essential for physical life?

Self Reflection***Inspiration***

How readily we give our love and devotion to our family and friends! How naturally we turn our loyalty towards our bosses and those in power! Yet, how little do we focus on the essential Source of all creation. Our own awareness, through which we experience and navigate this world and think our thoughts, is infused with energy and consciousness. The scriptures and sages prod us to come out of common human ignorance. They urge us to understand that essence which pervades the whole of creation, though it is not visible to our eyes and senses.

अग्निर्ज्योतिरहः शुक्लः षण्मासा उत्तरायणम् ।

तत्र प्रयाता गच्छन्ति ब्रह्म ब्रह्मविदो जनाः ॥ ८.२४ ॥

agnirjyōtirahaḥ śuklaḥ ṣaṇmāsā uttarāyaṇam ।

tatra prayātā gacchanti brahma brahmavidō janāḥ ॥ 8.24 ॥

Departing in the time of fire, light, day, the bright fortnight, and the six months of the sun's northern path, the knowers of *Brahman* attain *Brahman*.

धूमो रात्रिस्तथा कृष्णः षण्मासा दक्षिणायनम् ।

तत्र चान्द्रमसं ज्योतिर्योगी प्राप्य निवर्तते ॥ ८.२५ ॥

dhūmō rātristathā kṛṣṇaḥ ṣaṇmāsā dakṣiṇāyaṇam ।

tatra cāndramasaṁ jyōtiryōgī prāpya nivartatē ॥ 8.25 ॥

Departing in the time of smoke, night, the dark fortnight, and the six months of the sun's southern path, the *yogi* attains the moon's light and returns.

शुक्लकृष्णे गती ह्येते जगतः शाश्वते मते ।

एकया यात्यनावृत्तिमन्ययावर्तते पुनः ॥ ८.२६ ॥

śuklakṛṣṇē gatī hyētē jagataḥ śāśvatē matē ।

ekayā yātyanāvṛttimanyayāvartatē punaḥ ॥ 8.26 ॥

The bright and dark paths are eternal in the world's understanding. By one (the path of light), there is no return; by the other (the path of darkness), one returns again.

नैते सृती पार्थ जानन्योगी मुह्यति कश्चन ।

तस्मात्सर्वेषु कालेषु योगयुक्तो भवार्जुन ॥ ८.२७ ॥

naitē sṛtī pārtha jānanyōgī muhyati kaścana ।

tasmātsarvēṣu kālēṣu yōgayuktō bhavārjuna ॥ 8.27 ॥

O Pārtha, the *yogis* are not deluded by these two paths. Therefore, at all times, O Arjuna, be steadfast in *yoga*.

वेदेषु यज्ञेषु तपःसु चैव दानेषु यत्पुण्यफलं प्रदिष्टम् ।

अत्येति तत्सर्वमिदं विदित्वा योगी परं स्थानमुपैति चाद्यम् ॥ ८.२८ ॥

vēdēṣu yajñēṣu tapaḥsu caiva dānēṣu yatpuṇyaphalaṁ
pradiṣṭam ।

atyēti tatsarvamidaṁ viditvā yōgī paraṁ sthānamupaiti cādyam
॥ 8.28 ॥

The *yogi*, having known this teaching, surpasses all the merits declared from *vedic* study, sacrifices, austerities, and gifts, and attains the supreme, eternal abode.

Mananam Śloka – 28

How am I using the life choices available to me in this life based on the truths of the afterlife? To what extent do I believe in and practice the *vedic* injunctions related to rites, rituals, and offerings that are said to benefit my afterlife and that of my ancestors? Do I participate in charitable activities and good deeds merely for a sense of well-being, or also with the hope that their merits might accrue to me beyond this life? What knowledge or understanding have I acquired, or what practices am I undertaking now, which could aid me at the point of death? Are there any scripturally based teachings or practices that might help me prepare for the moment of death and beyond?

Self Reflection

Inspiration

Just as in life, where we are always presented with at least two options, so at the point of death, every departing soul has two paths to choose from: one that leads to a higher plane of existence and another that brings the majority back to Earth or to lower planes of existence, based on their stock of merits and sins. The *vedas* provide various rituals and sacrifices to aid in following the former path. However, the goal of a *yogi* is neither of these paths, as any choice therein is still bound by limitation. Through realization and abidance in Truth, a *yogi* attains the Supreme state of *Akṣara Brahma*, which is beyond all creation and beyond one's stock of virtues and sins. Having found that Completeness, the *yogi* seeks nothing else.

ॐ तत्सत्। इति श्रीमद्भगवद्गीतासूपनिषत्सु ब्रह्मविद्यायां योगशास्त्रे
श्रीकृष्णार्जुनसंवादे अक्षरब्रह्मयोगो नाम अष्टमोऽध्यायः ॥

ōm tatsaditi śrīmadbhagavadgītāsūpaniṣatsu brahmavidyāyām
yōgaśāstrē śrīkr̥ṣṇārjunasaṁvādē akṣarabrahmayōgō nāma
aṣṭamō'dhyāyaḥ॥



Chapter 9

Rāja Vidyā Rāja Guhya Yoga

(Yoga of Royal Knowledge and Secret)



श्रीभगवानुवाच —

इदं तु ते गुह्यतमं प्रवक्ष्याम्यनसूयवे ।

ज्ञानं विज्ञानसहितं यज्ज्ञात्वा मोक्ष्यसेऽशुभात् ॥ ९.१ ॥

śrībhagavānuvāca —

idaṁ tu tē guhyatamaṁ pravakṣyāmyanasūyavē ।

jñānaṁ vijñānasahitaṁ yajjñātvā mōkṣyasē:śubhāt ॥ 9.1 ॥

Sri Bhagavan said: I shall now declare to you, who are free from envy, this most secret knowledge, together with wisdom (its realisation). By knowing this, you shall be liberated from all that is inauspicious.

राजविद्या राजगुह्यं पवित्रमिदमुत्तमम् ।

प्रत्यक्षावगमं धर्म्यं सुसुखं कर्तुमव्ययम् ॥ ९.२ ॥

rājavidyā rājaguhyaṁ pavitramidamuttamam ।

pratyakṣāvagamaṁ dharmyaṁ

susukhaṁ kartumavyayaṁ ॥ 9.2 ॥

This royal knowledge (the king of sciences), the most profound of secrets, is supremely pure, directly realisable, righteous, easy to practise, and imperishable.

Mananam Śloka - 1, 2

Why is spiritual knowledge spoken of as hidden or secret, even though it is widely available? What qualities or traits might make someone ready to receive spiritual teachings? How does the progression to advanced levels of spiritual knowledge compare to a student progressing from high school to college? What are the similarities and differences in these paradigms? How might theoretical knowledge differ from spiritual wisdom? What signs or qualities might indicate that someone has attained true wisdom or the knowledge of spiritual realization? How might the attitudes and behaviours of those who are wise differ from those who only hold theoretical knowledge?

Self Reflection**Inspiration**

The sacred knowledge of spirituality is accessible only to those with a "royal mind"—one that is pure, surrendered, and disciplined. To attain this wisdom, one must cultivate a deep attunement with the *guru* and the tradition. In a sense, anything unknown to us remains a secret. Anything we haven't sought to discover or have found a teacher to reveal can also be considered hidden. Yet, in the boundlessness of God's mind, every mystery is waiting to be uncovered by those who are truly prepared and earnest in their search.

अश्रद्धधानाः पुरुषा धर्मस्यास्य परन्तप ।

अप्राप्य मां निवर्तन्ते मृत्युसंसारवर्त्मनि ॥ ९.३ ॥

aśraddadhānāḥ puruṣā dharmasyāśya parantapa ।
aprāpya mām nivartantē mṛtyusaṁsāravartmani ॥ 9.3 ॥

O Parantapa (scorcher of foes, Arjuna), those who lack faith in this *dharma* do not attain Me. They return to the path of death and rebirth in the cycle of *saṁsāra*.

मया ततमिदं सर्वं जगतदव्यक्तमूर्तिना ।

मत्स्थानि सर्वभूतानि न चाहं तेष्ववस्थितः ॥ ९.४ ॥

mayā tatamidaṁ sarvaṁ jagatadavyaktamūrtinā ।
matsthāni sarvabhūtāni na cāhaṁ tēṣvavasthitaḥ ॥ 9.4 ॥

By Me, in My unmanifest form, this entire universe is pervaded. All beings dwell in Me, yet I do not dwell in them (am not contained in them).

न च मत्स्थानि भूतानि पश्य मे योगमैश्वरम् ।

भूतभृन्न च भूतस्थो ममात्मा भूतभावनः ॥ ९.५ ॥

na ca matsthāni bhūtāni paśya mē yōgamaiśvaram ।
bhūtabhṛnna ca bhūtasthō mamātmā bhūtabhāvanaḥ ॥ 9.5 ॥

Nor do beings truly dwell in Me. Behold My divine *yoga*! Though I sustain all beings, I am my Self not contained within them. And yet, I am the source and nurturer of all beings.

यथाकाशस्थितो नित्यं वायुः सर्वत्रगो महान् ।

तथा सर्वाणि भूतानि मत्स्थानीत्युपधारय ॥ ९.६ ॥

yathākāśasthitō nityaṁ vāyuḥ sarvatragō mahān ।
tathā sarvāṇi bhūtāni matsthānītyupadhāraya ॥ 9.6 ॥

Just as the mighty wind, moving everywhere, always rests in space (*ākāśa*), so too, understand that all beings dwell in Me.

Mananam Śloka - 4, 5, 6

What hidden spiritual and scientific principles can we learn from observing space? Should we dismiss space as non-existent simply because it isn't as tangible as earth, water, or fire? Could any of nature's elements exist without space? Would wind move, fire rage, or water flow if space were non-existent? Yet, isn't space distinct and transcendent, beyond all other elements? In the same way, might it be possible to conceive a divine entity that sustains all existence while remaining distinct and transcendent?

Self Reflection***Inspiration***

The forces that uphold matter and are the support of all nature are not readily available to scientists despite their finest instruments and technology. Yet, the science behind the creation of this whole universe is quite easily accessible to those who have a subtle sense of observing, and who use the pointers left behind by the ancient sages who had fine inner instruments with which they could launch into a close observation of nature and its source.

सर्वभूतानि कौन्तेय प्रकृतिं यान्ति मामिकाम् ।

कल्पक्षये पुनस्तानि कल्पादौ विसृजाम्यहम् ॥ ९.७ ॥

sarvabhūtāni kauntēya prakṛtiṁ yānti māmikām ।
kalpakṣayē punastāni kalpādaū visṛjāmyaham ॥ 9.7 ॥

O Kaunteya (son of Kunti, Arjuna), at the end of a *kalpa* (cosmic cycle) all beings enter into My *prakṛti*; and at the beginning of the next *kalpa*, I send them forth again.

प्रकृतिं स्वामवष्टभ्य विसृजामि पुनः पुनः ।

भूतग्राममिमं कृत्स्नमवशं प्रकृतेर्वशात् ॥ ९.८ ॥

prakṛtiṁ svāmavaṣṭabhya visṛjāmi punaḥ punaḥ ।
bhūtagrāmamimam kṛtsnamavaśam prakṛtērvāśāt ॥ 9.8 ॥

Controlling My own *prakṛti*, I send forth again and again this entire multitude of beings, who are helplessly bound by the power of *prakṛti* (through *guṇas* and *karma*).

न च मां तानि कर्माणि निबध्नन्ति धनञ्जय ।

उदासीनवदासीनमसक्तं तेषु कर्मसु ॥ ९.९ ॥

na ca māṁ tāni karmāṇi nibadhnanti dhanañjaya ।
udāsīnavadāsīnamasaktam tēṣu karmasu ॥ 9.9 ॥

O Dhanañjaya (the winner of wealth, Arjuna), those actions do not bind Me. Remaining as if indifferent, unattached to those actions, I sit apart from them.

मयाध्यक्षेण प्रकृतिः सूयते सचराचरम् ।

हेतुनानेन कौन्तेय जगद्विपरिवर्तते ॥ ९.१० ॥

mayādhyaṁkṣeṇa prakṛtiḥ sūyatē sacarācaram ।
hētunānēna kauntēya jagadviparivartatē ॥ 9.10 ॥

Under My supervision, *prakṛti* brings forth the moving and the unmoving; by this cause, O Kaunteya, the world revolves.

अवजानन्ति मां मूढा मानुषीं तनुमाश्रितम् ।

परं भावमजानन्तो मम भूतमहेश्वरम् ॥ ९.११ ॥

avajānanti māṁ mūḍhā mānuṣīṁ tanumāśritam ।
param bhāvamajānanto mama bhūtamahēśvaram ॥ 9.11 ॥

Deluded men disregard Me when I dwell in a human form, not knowing My higher nature as the great Lord of all beings.

मोघाशा मोघकर्माणो मोघज्ञाना विचेतसः ।

राक्षसीमासुरीं चैव प्रकृतिं मोहिनीं श्रिताः ॥ ९.१२ ॥

mōghāśā mōghakarmāṇō mōghajñānā vicētasah |
rākṣasīmāsūrīm caiva prakṛtiṁ mōhinīm śritāḥ || 9.12 ||

Vain are their hopes, vain are their actions, vain are their knowledge; deluded in mind, they take refuge in the bewildering *prakṛti* nature of *rākṣasas* and *asuras*.

महात्मानस्तु मां पार्थ दैवीं प्रकृतिमाश्रिताः ।

भजन्त्यनन्यमनसो ज्ञात्वा भूतादिमव्ययम् ॥ ९.१३ ॥

mahātmānastu mām pārtha daivīm prakṛtimāśritāḥ |
bhajantyananyamanasō jñātvā bhūtādimavyayam || 9.13 ||

But the *mahatmas* (great souls), O Pārtha, taking refuge in the divine *prakṛti*, worship Me with single-minded devotion, knowing Me as the imperishable origin of all beings.

सततं कीर्तयन्तो मां यतन्तश्च दृढव्रताः ।

नमस्यन्तश्च मां भक्त्या नित्ययुक्ता उपासते ॥ ९.१४ ॥

satataṁ kīrtayantō mām yatantaśca dṛḍhavrataḥ |
namasyantaśca mām bhaktyā nityayuktā upāsate || 9.14 ||

Always chanting My glories, striving with firm vows, bowing down to Me with devotion, the ever-steadfast worship Me.

ज्ञानयज्ञेन चाप्यन्ये यजन्तो मामुपासते ।

एकत्वेन पृथक्त्वेन बहुधा विश्वतोमुखम् ॥ ९.१५ ॥

jñānayajñēna cāpyanyē yajantō māmupāsate |
ēkatvēna pṛthaktvēna bahudhā viśvatōmukham || 9.15 ||

Others, too, worship Me through the knowledge-sacrifice (*jñāna-yajña*); by seeing Me as one, as separate, and in many forms—as the Universal-faced (with faces everywhere).

Mananam Śloka – 12, 13

Where do my desires and aspirations come from? To what extent do my actions stem from my needs and wants? Do I pursue things based on my own direct knowledge, or am I influenced by what others claim is worth seeking? Do I pause to consider whether what I pursue will truly bring me happiness? What is the source of my beliefs—my culture, my upbringing, my experiences? How can I trace back to the origins of my understanding, my beliefs, and their formation? Can ignorance—of the higher reality of my own being and of God—truly be bliss?

** Self Reflection*****Inspiration***

What leads one person to atheism, another to theism, and others to become seekers? It is the dimension of their knowledge and understanding. Our pursuits and actions in life mirror the scope of our awareness. Without clear spiritual insight, we often focus solely on personal well-being, which reflects a state of spiritual ignorance. Staying content in ignorance may feel comfortable, but it is not lasting. Chasing fleeting moments of happiness, knowing that they provide only temporary satisfaction, means missing out on the potential for the happiness that endures and which comes from actions guided by the wisdom of a higher reality.

अहं क्रतुरहं यज्ञः स्वधाहमहमौषधम् ।

मन्त्रोऽहमहमेवाज्यमहमग्निरहं हुतम् ॥ ९.१६ ॥

aham kraturaham yajñah svadhāhamahamauśadham ।
mantrō:'hamahamēvājyamahamagniraham hutam ॥ 9.16 ॥

I am the *kratu* (Vedic ritual), I am the *yajña* (sacrifice), I am the *svadhā* (offering to the ancestors), I am the medicinal herb, I am the *mantra*, I am the clarified butter, I am the fire, and I am the oblation.

पिताहमस्य जगतो माता धाता पितामहः ।

वेद्यं पवित्रमोङ्कार ऋक्साम यजुरेव च ॥ ९.१७ ॥

pitāhamasya jagatō mātā dhātā pitāmahaḥ ।
vēdyaṁ pavitramōṅkāra ṛksāma yajurēva ca ॥ 9.17 ॥

I am the father of this world, the mother, the sustainer, and the grandsire. I am the object of knowledge, the purifier, the *omkāra*, and also the *Rg*, *Sāma*, and *Yajur Vedas*.

गतिर्भर्ता प्रभुः साक्षी निवासः शरणं सुहृत् ।

प्रभवः प्रलयः स्थानं निधानं बीजमव्ययम् ॥ ९.१८ ॥

gatirbhartā prabhuḥ sāksī nivāsaḥ śaraṇaṁ suhṛt ।
prabhavaḥ pralayaḥ sthānaṁ nidhānaṁ bījamavyayam ॥ 9.18 ॥

I am the goal, the sustainer, the Lord, the witness, the abode, the refuge, the friend. I am the origin, the dissolution, the foundation, the treasure, and the imperishable seed.

तपाम्यहमहं वर्षं निगृह्णाम्युत्सृजामि च ।

अमृतं चैव मृत्युश्च सदसच्चाहमर्जुन ॥ ९.१९ ॥

tapāmyahamaham varṣaṁ nigrhṇāmyutsrjāmi ca ।
amṛtaṁ caiva mṛtyuśca sadasaccāhamarjuna ॥ 9.19 ॥

I am the source of heat; I bring forth rain and also withhold it. I am immortality and also death, and existence and non-existence, O Arjuna.

Mananam Śloka – 18, 19

What is the nature of the ultimate source of all creation? Could it also be the final destination for all beings? Could the entity that initiated creation also be responsible for its dissolution, as some scriptures suggest? How might that entity exert influence over me and other beings? Could it be the controlling force behind my birth, life, and death? What value is there in seeking answers to these questions? Is it better to let others uncover these truths and reveal them to me? And, in matters like these, can the answers that others provide me be truly satisfying?

** Self Reflection*****Inspiration***

From time immemorial, humanity has sought to unravel the origin of all creation. Theories abound—from belief in a single controlling entity to the idea that such a single creator doesn't exist—captivating scientists and philosophers alike. Through our natural tendency for cause-hunting, it seems logical to infer that there must be an ultimate source from which even the Big Bang emerged. Yet, how can we be certain that this ultimate cause itself has no prior cause? To reconcile these possibilities, the Lord encompasses both ideas: that of a personal God, and that of an impersonal Reality beyond causation—a transcendental truth of which the universe is merely a shadow.

त्रैविद्या मां सोमपाः पूतपापा यज्ञैरिष्ट्वा स्वर्गतिं प्रार्थयन्ते ।
ते पुण्यमासाद्य सुरेन्द्रलोकमश्नन्ति दिव्यान्दिवि देवभोगान् ॥ ९.२० ॥

traividya māṁ sōmapāḥ pūtapāpā
yajñairiṣṭvā svargatiṁ prārthayantē |
tē puṇyamāsādyā surēndralōkamaśnanti
divyāndivi dēvabhōgān || 9.20 ||

Those who are versed in the three *Vedas*, who drink the *soma* and are purified of sin, worship Me through sacrifices and seek heaven. Attaining the world of Indra (the Lord of demi-gods), they enjoy the divine pleasures of the gods in heaven.

ते तं भुक्त्वा स्वर्गलोकं विशालं क्षीणे पुण्ये मर्त्यलोकं विशन्ति ।
एवं त्रयीधर्ममनुप्रपन्ना गतागतं कामकामा लभन्ते ॥ ९.२१ ॥

tē taṁ bhuktvā svargalōkaṁ viśālaṁ
kṣīṇē puṇyē martyalōkaṁ viśanti |
ēvaṁ trayīdharmamanuprapannā
gatāgataṁ kāmakāmā labhantē || 9.21 ||

They, having enjoyed the vast heavenly world, when their merit is exhausted, return to the mortal realm. Thus, those who follow the threefold *Vedic* path, desiring pleasures, attain only repeated coming and going (of *saṁsāra*).

अनन्याश्चिन्तयन्तो मां ये जनाः पर्युपासते ।
तेषां नित्याभियुक्तानां योगक्षेमं वहाम्यहम् ॥ ९.२२ ॥

ananyāścintayantō māṁ yē janāḥ paryupāsatē |
tēṣāṁ nityābhiyuktānāṁ yōgākṣemaṁ vahāmyaham || 9.22 ||

Those who, thinking of none other, worship Me alone with undivided devotion—to them, ever steadfast, I provide what they lack (*yoga*) and preserve what they already have (*kṣema*).

Mananam Śloka - 22

Which of life's two pursuits engages my mind more—acquiring what I do not yet have, or preserving what I already possess? What specific aspects fall into each of these categories for me? How much control do I truly have over elements such as health, wealth, social status, and success? Can I place my trust in a higher justice system or divine order to provide for my needs and safeguard me, while I make an earnest effort to live righteously?

Self Reflection***Inspiration***

We all have a choice: to immerse ourselves in chasing our needs and desires, or to place our focus on the Divine. Practical-minded people might suggest prioritising worldly concerns, as these seem more immediate and tangible. However, the Lord assures us that when we fulfil our duties and dedicate time daily for genuine contemplation and devotion, He will provide for our needs and protect our worldly gains. For those who have faith, trusting in the Divine brings both spiritual and material rewards.

येऽप्यन्यदेवताभक्ता यजन्ते श्रद्धयान्विताः ।

तेऽपि मामेव कौन्तेय यजन्त्यविधिपूर्वकम् ॥ ९.२३ ॥

yē:'pyanyadēvatābhaktā yajantē śraddhayānvitāḥ ।
tē:'pi māmēva kauntēya yajantyavidhipūrvakam ॥ 9.23 ॥

Even those devotees who, with faith, worship other deities, O Kaunteya, they too worship Me alone—but in a manner not according to the proper method.

अहं हि सर्वयज्ञानां भोक्ता च प्रभुरेव च ।

न तु मामभिजानन्ति तत्त्वेनातश्च्यवन्ति ते ॥ ९.२४ ॥

aham hi sarvayajñānām bhōktā ca prabhurēva ca ।
na tu māmabhijānanti tattvēnātaśchyavanti tē ॥ 9.24 ॥

For I am indeed the enjoyer and the Lord of all sacrifices. But they do not know Me in truth; therefore, they fall away (do not gain liberation).

यान्ति देवव्रता देवान्पितृन्यान्ति पितृव्रताः ।

भूतानि यान्ति भूतेज्या यान्ति मद्याजिनोऽपि माम् ॥ ९.२५ ॥

yānti dēvavratā dēvānpitṛnyānti pitṛvratāḥ ।
bhūtāni yānti bhūtējyā yānti madyājinō:'pi mām ॥ 9.25 ॥

Worshippers of the gods (*devas*) go to the gods; worshippers of the ancestors (*pitṛs*) go to the ancestors; worshippers of spirits (*bhūtās*) go to the spirits; but those who worship Me come to Me.

पत्रं पुष्पं फलं तोयं यो मे भक्त्या प्रयच्छति ।

तदहं भक्त्युपहृतमश्नामि प्रयतात्मनः ॥ ९.२६ ॥

patraṁ puṣpaṁ phalaṁ tōyaṁ yō mē bhaktyā prayacchati ।
tadahaṁ bhaktyupahṛtamaśnāmi prayatātmanaḥ ॥ 9.26 ॥

Whoever offers Me with devotion a leaf, a flower, a fruit, or water—I accept that offering, made with devotion by one of pure heart.

Mananam Śloka - 25, 26

What motivates you to perform good deeds or rituals? Do you do them simply because you've been told they will bring specific benefits? Do you possess enough understanding to pray or offer your devotion to the Divine with complete trust and sincerity? Have you ever felt gratitude for a kind gesture from a loved one? In the same way, could you offer something as simple as a flower or fruit to the Lord, filled with pure devotion? When you do this, doesn't it leave an uplifting, transformative effect on your state of mind?

** Self Reflection*****Inspiration***

Clear understanding of physical, verbal, and mental acts of worship and their purpose is superior to merely going through their ritualistic steps. When our devotion is directed toward lesser beings or deities who can fulfil our desires, we become indebted to them. However, if our devotion is toward the one Supreme God, the essence of our being, we are blessed with spiritual realisation and liberation. When we purify our hearts of worldly desires and offer anything to God or to holy persons, we are rewarded manifold. Even if we offer nothing material, entering deeply into the Divine presence with a pure heart is a powerful remedy for psychological distress, as it brings an immediate, transformative sense of peace and joy.

यत्करोषि यदश्नासि यज्जुहोषि ददासि यत् ।

यत्तपस्यसि कौन्तेय तत्कुरुष्व मदर्पणम् ॥ ९.२७ ॥

yatkarōṣi yadaśnāsi yajjuhōṣi dadāsi yat ।

yattapasyasi kauntēya tatkuruṣva madarpaṇam ॥ 9.27 ॥

Whatever you do, whatever you eat, whatever you offer in sacrifice, whatever you give, whatever austerity you practise—O Kaunteya, do that as an offering to Me.

शुभाशुभफलैरेवं मोक्ष्यसे कर्मबन्धनैः ।

संन्यासयोगयुक्तात्मा विमुक्तो मामुपैष्यसि ॥ ९.२८ ॥

śubhāśubhaphalairēvaṁ mōkṣyasē karmabandhanaiḥ ।

saṁnyāsayōgayuktātmā vimuktō māmupaiṣyasi ॥ 9.28 ॥

Thus, you shall be freed from the bonds of action, with their auspicious and inauspicious fruits. With the mind united in the *yoga* of renunciation, liberated, you shall come to Me.

समोऽहं सर्वभूतेषु न मे द्वेष्योऽस्ति न प्रियः ।

ये भजन्ति तु मां भक्त्या मयि ते तेषु चाप्यहम् ॥ ९.२९ ॥

samō:'haṁ sarvabhūtēṣu na mē dvēṣyō:'sti na priyaḥ ।

yē bhajanti tu mām bhaktyā mayi tē tēṣu cāpyaham ॥ 9.29 ॥

I am equal to all beings; none is hateful to Me, nor is anyone dearer than another. Yet those who worship Me with devotion—they are in Me, and I am in them.

अपि चेत्सुदुराचारो भजते मामनन्यभाक् ।

साधुरेव स मन्तव्यः सम्यग्व्यवसितो हि सः ॥ ९.३० ॥

api cētsudurācārō bhajatē māmananyabhāk ।

sādhurēva sa mantavyaḥ samyagvyavasitō hi saḥ ॥ 9.30 ॥

Even if a person of very sinful conduct worships Me with undivided devotion (or with devotion to none else), he should be regarded as righteous, for such a one has rightly resolved.

Mananam Śloka - 29, 30

Could the Lord of the universe show favouritism towards certain individuals? What determines who receives grace and blessings? Is there a difference between divine grace and the results of *karma*? What is the significance of being devoted to God and surrendering our actions to Him? How might this mindset shape our actions and affect the rewards we receive? Is there no hope for the blessings of spiritual growth for those new to the spiritual path, or for those who find it difficult to maintain faith? Are individuals who lack faith inferior in their essential nature to those naturally gifted with it?

Self Reflection**Inspiration**

If the Lord were to show bias or favouritism, He would be more human than divine. While partiality is common among businessmen and some political leaders, it is not fitting for the Supreme Lord of the Universe. However, those who adopt the right attitude, surrender to the Divine, and follow the path of righteousness are rightly rewarded with special grace and blessings. Even those who stray from the righteous path can receive divine grace as soon as they change their ways, much like a mischievous child who is immediately forgiven and embraced by a loving mother when she corrects his behaviour.

क्षिप्रं भवति धर्मात्मा शश्वच्छान्तिं निगच्छति ।

कौन्तेय प्रतिजानीहि न मे भक्तः प्रणश्यति ॥ ९.३१ ॥

kṣipraṁ bhavati dharmātmā śaśvacchāntiṁ nigacchati ।
kauntēya pratijānīhi na mē bhaktaḥ praṇaśyati ॥ 9.31 ॥

Such a one quickly becomes righteous (undergoing self-transformation), and attains eternal peace. O Kaunteya, know with certainty: My devotee never perishes.

मां हि पार्थ व्यपाश्रित्य येऽपि स्युः पापयोनयः ।

स्त्रियो वैश्यास्तथा शूद्रास्तेऽपि यान्ति परां गतिम् ॥ ९.३२ ॥

mām hi pārtha vyapāśritya yē:'pi syuḥ pāpayōnayaḥ ।
striyō vaiśyāstathā śūdrāstē:'pi yānti parāṁ gatiṁ ॥ 9.32 ॥

O Pārtha, for those who take refuge in Me—even if they are of sinful birth, women, *vaiśyas* (merchants), or *śūdras* (labourers)—they too attain the supreme goal.

किं पुनर्ब्राह्मणाः पुण्या भक्ता राजर्षयस्तथा ।

अनित्यमसुखं लोकमिमं प्राप्य भजस्व माम् ॥ ९.३३ ॥

kiṁ punarbrāhmaṇāḥ puṇyā bhaktā rājarṣayastathā ।
anityamasukhaṁ lōkamimaṁ prāpya bhajasva mām ॥ 9.33 ॥

How much more, then, the holy *brāhmaṇas* and devoted royal sages! Having come into this transient and joyless world, worship Me (with devotion).

मन्मना भव मद्भक्तो मद्याजी मां नमस्कुरु ।

मामेवैष्यसि युक्तवैवमात्मानं मत्परायणः ॥ ९.३४ ॥

manmanā bhava madbhaktō madyājī mām namaskuru ।
māmēvaiśyasi yuktvaivamātmānaṁ matparāyaṇaḥ ॥ 9.34 ॥

Fix your mind on Me, become My devotee, worship Me, bow down to Me. Thus, uniting the Self with Me, regarding Me as supreme, you shall surely come to Me.

Mananam Śloka - 34

What changes can I make in my attitude to restore my divine status and connection with the ultimate Divine Being? How does bowing and serving a human authority differ from surrendering to the Divine? Could the Lord ever manipulate us for His own purposes as might an authoritative human? What kind of relationship exists between the Divine and me? Why is it considered the ultimate goal of life to re-establish or reclaim our true identity with the Divine?

 Self Reflection***Inspiration***

An immediate path to finding peace and adopting the right attitude is to inwardly surrender to life. Whether or not events go our way, people act as we wish, or our body and mind are in harmony, these factors are not always within our control. Yet, as life takes its course, we can cling to the one unchanging anchor of our lives—Whose love is unconditional and unchanged by life's circumstances.

ॐ तत्सत् । इति श्रीमद्भगवद्गीतासूपनिषत्सु ब्रह्मविद्यायां योगशास्त्रे
श्रीकृष्णार्जुनसंवादे राजविद्याराजगुह्ययोगो नाम नवमोऽध्यायः ॥

ōm tatsaditi śrīmadbhagavadgītāsūpaniṣatsu brahmavidyāyām
yōgaśāstrē śrīkṛṣṇārjunasaṁvādē rājavidyārājaguhyayōgō
nāma navamō'dhyāyaḥ॥



Chapter 10

Vibhūti Yoga

(Yoga of Divine Glories)



श्रीभगवानुवाच —

भूय एव महाबाहो शृणु मे परमं वचः ।

यत्तेऽहं प्रीयमाणाय वक्ष्यामि हितकाम्यया ॥ १०.१ ॥

śrībhagavānuvāca —

bhūya ēva mahābāhō śṛṇu mē paramaṁ vacaḥ ।

yattē:'haṁ prīyamāṇāya vakṣyāmi hitakāmyayā ॥ 10.1 ॥

Sri Bhagavan said: O Mahābāho (mighty-armed one, Arjuna), listen once again to My Supreme word. Because you are dear to me, I shall speak these words for your benefit and well-being.

न मे विदुः सुरगणाः प्रभवं न महर्षयः ।

अहमादिर्हि देवानां महर्षीणां च सर्वशः ॥ १०.२ ॥

na mē viduḥ suragaṇāḥ prabhavaṁ na maharṣayaḥ ।

ahamādirhi dēvānāṁ maharṣīṇāṁ ca sarvaśaḥ ॥ 10.2 ॥

Neither the hosts of gods nor the great sages know My origin, for in every way, I am the source of the gods and the great sages.

Mananam Śloka - 2, 3

What is my concept of God, or the force behind creation? What is the nature of the entity that sustains all creation and enables our internal systems to function in harmony? Could it also have a beginning like all of us? If so, would it also be subject to an end? What is the status of other subsidiary gods and sages in relation to this Supreme God? How might I benefit from learning and gaining clarity on the nature of the Supreme God?

Self Reflection***Inspiration***

The One Universal Force, the source of all other forces, from which everything arises and into which all dissolves, is the ultimate reality worthy of our highest pursuit. How can we truly know or understand this entity if we remain confined to the human intellect's analytical and deductive processes? This entity, beyond cause and effect, without birth or death, can only be known and realised through the guidance of the scriptures and qualified teachers. By embracing the right sources of knowledge, we remain connected with God as the source of this world, rather than getting lost in God's projection.

यो मामजमनादिं च वेत्ति लोकमहेश्वरम् ।

असंमूढः स मर्त्येषु सर्वपापैः प्रमुच्यते ॥ १०.३ ॥

yō māmajamanādīm ca vētti lōkamahēśvaram ।

asaṁmūḍhaḥ sa martyēṣu sarvapāpaiḥ pramucyatē ॥ 10.3 ॥

He who knows Me as unborn, without beginning, and the Supreme Lord of all worlds—such a one, who is undeluded among mortals, is liberated from all sins.

बुद्धिर्ज्ञानमसंमोहः क्षमा सत्यं दमः शमः ।

सुखं दुःखं भवोऽभावो भयं चाभयमेव च ॥ १०.४ ॥

buddhirjñānamasaṁmōhaḥ kṣamā

satyaṁ damaḥ śamaḥ ।

sukhaṁ duḥkhaṁ bhavō:'bhāvō

bhayaṁ cābhayaṁēva ca ॥ 10.4 ॥

Intelligence, knowledge, freedom from delusion, forgiveness, truthfulness, control of the senses, control of the mind, pleasure and pain, birth and death, fear and fearlessness.

अहिंसा समता तुष्टिस्तपो दानं यशोऽयशः ।

भवन्ति भावा भूतानां मत्त एव पृथग्विधाः ॥ १०.५ ॥

ahiṁsā samatā tuṣṭistapō dānaṁ yaśō:'yaśaḥ ।

bhavanti bhāvā bhūtānāṁ matta ēva pṛthagvidhāḥ ॥ 10.5 ॥

Nonviolence, equanimity, contentment, austerity, charity, fame and infamy—all these diverse qualities of living beings arise from Me alone.

महर्षयः सप्त पूर्वे चत्वारो मनवस्तथा ।

मद्भावा मानसा जाता येषां लोक इमाः प्रजाः ॥ १०.६ ॥

maharṣayaḥ sapta pūrvē catvārō manavastathā ।

madbhāvā mānasā jātā yēṣāṁ lōka imāḥ prajāḥ ॥ 10.6 ॥

The seven great sages, the four other great sages before them, the ancient *manus* (progenitors of mankind), who are endowed with my essence, were born from My mind. From them, all the creatures of this world have originated.

Mananam Śloka - 4, 5

What are the qualities of a wise person? Does being spiritually inclined help us to develop these qualities? What else shapes someone who embodies these positive traits? What is the role of daily life practice and training in cultivating a loving, kind, self-controlled, and equanimous nature? Is such a disposition sustained by maintaining the right attitude? Can these qualities be attained by someone who lacks spiritual wisdom? If not, why not?

Self Reflection***Inspiration***

All positive qualities find their perfection in the Lord, whom all spiritually inclined people seek and revere. To truly understand the pure essence of any of these qualities is to know the Lord. Conversely, ignorance of the Lord prevents the realisation of pure love, calmness, happiness, and other virtues. Knowing the Lord does not mean experiencing a supernatural vision of the Lord in a specific form, but recognising the essence of Being itself—the source of all creation. Gaining wisdom about the Lord and His qualities is the most effective way to cultivate, strengthen, and sustain all positive qualities in life.

एतां विभूतिं योगं च मम यो वेत्ति तत्त्वतः ।

सोऽविकम्पेन योगेन युज्यते नात्र संशयः ॥ १०.७ ॥

ētām vibhūtiṁ yōgaṁ ca mama yō vētti tattvataḥ ।
sō:'vikampēna yōgēna yujyatē nātra saṁśayaḥ ॥ 10.7 ॥

He who knows My divine glories (*vibhūti*) and My *yoga* power in their true essence, achieve unwavering union through *yoga*—there is no doubt about this.

अहं सर्वस्य प्रभवो मत्तः सर्वं प्रवर्तते ।

इति मत्वा भजन्ते मां बुधा भावसमन्विताः ॥ १०.८ ॥

ahaṁ sarvasya prabhavō mattaḥ sarvaṁ pravartatē ।
iti matvā bhajantē mām budhā bhāvasamanvitāḥ ॥ 10.8 ॥

I am the source of all creation; from Me everything emanates; knowing thus, the wise endowed with devotional feeling (*bhāva*) worship Me.

मच्चित्ता मद्गतप्राणा बोधयन्तः परस्परम् ।

कथयन्तश्च मां नित्यं तुष्यन्ति च रमन्ति च ॥ १०.९ ॥

maccittā madgataprāṇā bōdhayantaḥ parasparam ।
kathayantaśca mām nityaṁ tuṣyanti ca ramanti ca ॥ 10.9 ॥

With minds absorbed on Me and senses devoted to Me, mutually sharing wisdom (about Me) and always speaking of Me, My devotees derive contentment and delight.

तेषां सततयुक्तानां भजतां प्रीतिपूर्वकम् ।

ददामि बुद्धियोगं तं येन मामुपयान्ति ते ॥ १०.१० ॥

tēṣāṁ satatayuktānām bhajatām prītipūrvakam ।
dadāmi buddhiyōgaṁ taṁ yēna māmupayānti tē ॥ 10.10 ॥

To those who are ever steadfast, worship Me with love, I grant the *yoga* of wisdom (*buddhi-yogam*) which enables them to come to Me.

Mananam Śloka - 7

How can learning about the various manifestations of divine power benefit me? Am I also endowed with this divine power such that I am able to manifest certain ideals in my life? How may I awaken, cultivate, and develop the Lord's *yogic* power within myself? What unique talents do I have that I can start developing further? What impedes me from expressing my creativity through my work, hobbies, or other activities? Which areas of my life can I focus on to further develop my creative potential?

 Self Reflection**Inspiration**

Just as the Divine possesses the ability to create and manifest a vast range of life expressions, humans too are endowed with the power of creativity. Those who learn to harness this ability are able to tap into their inherent divine potential. Sustaining positive thoughts and diligently working toward them is the foundation of success in any field. This '*yoga*'—the practice of steadfastly holding onto one's goals and ideals with divine faith and surrender, despite trials and challenges—serves as a bridge connecting us to the divine essence within ourselves.

Mananam Śloka - 8, 9

What reasons and needs make seeking refuge in the Lord essential? In what ways can the Lord be the ultimate source of refuge and comfort? Why might seeking refuge in power, money, and material goods be insufficient? If we are finding support and comfort in family and friends, should we still prioritise seeking refuge in the Lord first? How can seeking refuge in the Lord—while encouraging our loved ones to do the same—be a way toward experiencing genuine fulfilment? What distinguishes consciously and wisely seeking refuge in the Lord from doing so out of blind faith and ignorance of His true nature?

Self Reflection***Inspiration***

You cannot truly love someone you do not know well. Infatuation may seemingly mirror love, but those with maturity understand that infatuations are fleeting. Similarly, when we come to understand who the Lord truly is and how He is the very essence of our being, we naturally learn to turn to that One whose unwavering love and support remain the only constant in this ever-changing world. Those from whom we seek comfort—whether friends or family—may change their hearts or may not always be near us when we need them. When our love for the Lord arises from genuine understanding, it brings a steady purpose to the mind. Love driven merely by impulse or fleeting emotion will inevitably fade as quickly as it appears.

तेषामेवानुकम्पार्थमहमज्ञानजं तमः ।

नाशयाम्यात्मभावस्थो ज्ञानदीपेन भास्वता ॥ १०.११ ॥

tēṣāmēvānukampāṛthamahamajñānajaṁ tamaḥ ।
nāśayāmyātmabhāvasthō jñānadīpēna bhāsvatā ॥ 10.11 ॥

Out of mere compassion for them, I dwell in their hearts and destroy the darkness born of ignorance with the radiant lamp of knowledge.

अर्जुन उवाच —

परं ब्रह्म परं धाम पवित्रं परमं भवान् ।

पुरुषं शाश्वतं दिव्यमादिदेवमजं विभुम् ॥ १०.१२ ॥

arjuna uvāca —
param brahma param dhāma pavitraṁ paramaṁ bhavān ।
puruṣaṁ śāśvataṁ divyamādidēvamajaṁ vibhum ॥ 10.12 ॥

Arjuna said: You are the Supreme *Brahman*, the Supreme Abode, the Supreme Purifier. You are the eternal Divine *Puruṣa*, the primal God, unborn and omnipresent.

आहुस्त्वामृषयः सर्वे देवर्षिर्नारदस्तथा ।

असितो देवलो व्यासः स्वयं चैव ब्रवीषि मे ॥ १०.१३ ॥

āhustvāmṛṣayaḥ sarvē dēvaṛṣirnāradastathā ।
asitō dēvalō vyāsaḥ svayaṁ caiva bravīṣi mē ॥ 10.13 ॥

All the sages proclaim You as such; so too does the divine sage Nārada, as well as Asita, Devala, and Vyāsa. And now You Yourself declare it to me.

सर्वमेतदृतं मन्ये यन्मां वदसि केशव ।

न हि ते भगवन्व्यक्तिं विदुर्देवा न दानवाः ॥ १०.१४ ॥

sarvamētaḍṛtaṁ manyē yanmāṁ vadasi kēśava ।
na hi tē bhagavanvyaktiṁ vidurdēvā na dānavāḥ ॥ 10.14 ॥

I believe everything You say to me is true, O Keśava (Krishna). Neither the gods nor the demons comprehend Your true nature, O Lord.

Mananam Śloka – 10, 11

Why do sages regard wisdom, in its purest and most unfiltered form, as the most sacred pursuit? Should we not, instead, seek special powers to manifest our aspirations and worthwhile dreams? If not, why not? What might be the outcome when our ignorance is completely destroyed? How does the wisdom of the Lord differ from the knowledge of nature's workings, as part of God's creation? What is my understanding of "*buddhi-yoga*"?

Self Reflection**Inspiration**

The fruit of all spiritual practices and devotion to the Lord is the blessing of "*buddhi-yoga*." With this divine wisdom, we uproot the very cause of *saṁsāra*— the intricate web of worldly existence that has kept us bound for countless lifetimes. The darkness of ignorance is so profound that the Lord, who is the very essence of our being and dwells within us, remains unnoticed. When our spiritual practices reach their peak, our devotion becomes pure, and our discernment of reality—honed by the guidance of the *guru* and the *śāstras*—grows razor-sharp. It is then that we receive the grace of the Lord, culminating in God-realisation.

स्वयमेवात्मनात्मानं वेत्थ त्वं पुरुषोत्तम ।

भूतभावन भूतेश देवदेव जगत्पते ॥ १०.१५ ॥

svayamēvātmanātmānaṁ vēttha tvaṁ puruṣōttama ।
bhūtabhāvana bhūteśa dēvadēva jagatpatē ॥ 10.15 ॥

Indeed, You alone know Your true nature through Your own Self-awareness, O *Puruṣottama* (Supreme Person), *Bhūtabhāvana* (Origin of all beings), *Bhūteśa* (Lord of all beings), *Devadeva* (God of gods) and *Jagatpate* (Lord of the universe).

वक्तुमर्हस्यशेषेण दिव्या ह्यात्मविभूतयः ।

याभिर्विभूतिभिर्लोकानिमांस्त्वं व्याप्य तिष्ठसि ॥ १०.१६ ॥

vaktumarhasyaśēṣēṇa divyā hyātmavibhūtayāḥ ।
yābhirvibhūtibhirlōkānimāṁstvāṁ vyāpya tiṣṭhasi ॥ 10.16 ॥

Please describe to me in detail Your divine glories, by which You pervade all these worlds and reside in them.

कथं विद्यामहं योगिस्त्वां सदा परिचिन्तयन् ।

केषु केषु च भावेषु चिन्त्योऽसि भगवन्मया ॥ १०.१७ ॥

katham vidyāmaḥam yōginstvāṁ sadā paricintayan ।
kēṣu kēṣu ca bhāvēṣu cintyō:'si bhagavanmayā ॥ 10.17 ॥

O *Yogin* (Krishna) how may I, ever-meditating, know You? In what various forms (or aspects) are You to be contemplated by me, O Blessed Lord?

विस्तरेणात्मनो योगं विभूतिं च जनार्दन ।

भूयः कथय तृप्तिर्हि शृण्वतो नास्ति मेऽमृतम् ॥ १०.१८ ॥

vistarēṇātmanō yōgaṁ vibhūtiṁ ca janārdana ।
bhūyaḥ kathaya tṛptirhi śṛṇvatō nāsti mē:'mṛtam ॥ 10.18 ॥

O Janārdana (maintainer of all living beings, Krishna), please describe again in detail Your divine glories and *yoga*; for I am never satisfied while hearing Your nectar-like words.

Mananam Śloka – 17, 18

Is the Supreme Divine Being confined to a specific form, like humans? What would happen if God were limited in power and capacity? Could it be beneficial to understand God beyond a single form? How can I discover which image or aspect of the Divine is most suitable for me to meditate upon? Would it be helpful to meditate upon or pray to different aspects of God based on my changing mental states? Can I use my God-given creativity to visualise and conceptualise a divine image that resonates with me personally?

** Self Reflection*****Inspiration***

Our human understanding of God will always be limited, as only the Lord can fully reveal His true nature. While it is helpful to seek the Lord in a personal, human form, He is not confined to any single form. The grandest, purest, and most sublime aspects of all creation reflect the presence of the Lord. Therefore, in every moment of conscious living, we can find opportunities to remember and contemplate Him.

श्रीभगवानुवाच —

हन्त ते कथयिष्यामि दिव्या ह्यात्मविभूतयः ।

प्राधान्यतः कुरुश्रेष्ठ नास्त्यन्तो विस्तरस्य मे ॥ १०.१९ ॥

śrībhagavānuvāca —

hanta tē kathayiṣyāmi divyā hyātmavibhūtaḥ ।

prādhānyataḥ kuruśreṣṭha nāstyantō vistarasya mē ॥ 10.19 ॥

Sri Bhagavan said: Indeed, I shall now describe to you My divine glories, O *kuru-śhreṣṭha* (best of the Kurus, Arjuna), but only the most prominent ones—for there is no end to the extent of My manifestations.

अहमात्मा गुडाकेश सर्वभूताशयस्थितः ।

अहमादिश्च मध्यं च भूतानामन्त एव च ॥ १०.२० ॥

ahamātmā guḍākēśa sarvabhūtāśayasthitaḥ ।

ahamādiśca madhyaṁ ca bhūtānāmanta ēva ca ॥ 10.20 ॥

O Guḍākēśa (conqueror of sleep, Arjuna), I am the Self dwelling in the hearts of all beings. I am the beginning, the middle, and the end of all beings.

आदित्यानामहं विष्णुर्ज्योतिषां रविरंशुमान् ।

मरीचिर्मरुतामस्मि नक्षत्राणामहं शशी ॥ १०.२१ ॥

ādityānāmahaṁ viṣṇurjyōtiṣāṁ raviraṁśumān ।

marīcirmarutāmasmi nakṣatrāṇāmahaṁ śaśī ॥ 10.21 ॥

Among the *Ādityas* (twelve deities representing different aspects of the sun) I am Viṣṇu; among luminaries I am the radiant sun. Among the *Maruts* (storm-gods) I am Marīchi, and among the stars I am the moon.

वेदानां सामवेदोऽस्मि देवानामस्मि वासवः ।

इन्द्रियाणां मनश्चास्मि भूतानामस्मि चेतना ॥ १०.२२ ॥

vēdānāṁ sāmavēdō'smi dēvānāmasmi vāsavaḥ ।

indriyāṇāṁ manaścāsmi bhūtānāmasmi cētanā ॥ 10.22 ॥

Among the vedas I am the *Sāma veda*; of the gods I am *Vāsava* (Indra, king of heaven). Among the senses I am the mind, and among living beings I am *cetanā*, the sentient principle.

Mananam Śloka - 20

How can I perceive God dwelling within my heart? Does this refer to the physical heart or the spiritual heart? In what way can God be my very Self? What is the nature of my innermost Self? When it is said that God is the beginning of all beings, does it refer to the act of world creation? If God is also present in the middle and end of all beings, how can I comprehend such an uninterrupted stream of existence?

Self Reflection***Inspiration***

The very essence of our being, the pure awareness we identify as “I am” without any further labels, is the Supreme Lord Himself. This supreme, pure existence is what enables us to become this conscious individual and experience life. The core of all knowing and beingness is the Lord alone. As finite beings, we arise from the vast ocean of the Lord’s existence, express ourselves as individual waves of life, and ultimately merge back into that infinite ocean.

Mananam Śloka - 21, 22

Does the sun's brilliance not surpass all other sources of light? Does the moon not outshine all the stars? Meditate on God as the brightest and most radiant among all shining entities. Can my senses operate without the mind? Can my mind function without intelligence? Can the various aspects of my body and mind work without consciousness? Reflect on that higher intelligence—the unifying force behind the functioning of the senses, mind, and intellect.

Self Reflection***Inspiration***

Among all natural lights—fire, the moon, stars, and lightning—the sun shines the brightest. God can be meditated upon as the supreme light in this world, yet ultimately, He is the Light of all lights.

In the same way, God is the light of consciousness. It is His divine light that illuminates the mind, enabling it to receive input from the senses and empowering the intelligence to make decisions.

रुद्राणां शङ्करश्चास्मि वित्तेशो यक्षरक्षसाम् ।

वसूनां पावकश्चास्मि मेरुः शिखरिणामहम् ॥ १०.२३ ॥

rudrāṇām śaṅkaraścāsmi vittēśō yakṣarakṣasām ।
vasūnām pāvakaścāsmi mēruḥ śikhariṇāmaham ॥ 10.23 ॥

Among the *Rudras*, I am Śaṅkara (Śiva); among the *Yakṣas* and *Rākṣasas*, I am Kubera, the lord of wealth; among the *Vasus*, I am Agni (fire); and among mountains, I am Meru, the highest peak.

पुरोधसां च मुख्यं मां विद्धि पार्थ बृहस्पतिम् ।

सेनानीनामहं स्कन्दः सरसामस्मि सागरः ॥ १०.२४ ॥

purōdhasām ca mukhyaṁ mām viddhi pārtha bṛhaspatim ।
sēnānīnāmaham skandaḥ sarasāmasmi sāgaraḥ ॥ 10.24 ॥

Among priests, O Pārtha, know Me to be the chief, Bṛhaspati (the celestial priest). Among army commanders I am Skanda (the god of war, Karthikeya), and among reservoirs of water I am the ocean.

महर्षीणां भृगुरहं गिरामस्म्येकमक्षरम् ।

यज्ञानां जपयज्ञोऽस्मि स्थावराणां हिमालयः ॥ १०.२५ ॥

maharṣīṇām bṛguraham girāmasmyēkamakṣaram ।
yajñānām japayajñō'smi sthāvarāṇām himālayaḥ ॥ 10.25 ॥

Among the great sages I am Bhṛigu; Among words I am the syllable *Om*. Among sacrifices I am *japa* (silent repetition of the holy names), and among immovable things I am the Himalayas.

अश्वत्थः सर्ववृक्षाणां देवर्षीणां च नारदः ।

गन्धर्वाणां चित्ररथः सिद्धानां कपिलो मुनिः ॥ १०.२६ ॥

aśvatthaḥ sarvavṛkṣāṇām dēvarṣīṇām ca nāradaḥ ।
gandharvāṇām citrarathaḥ siddhānām kapilō muniḥ ॥ 10.26 ॥

Among all trees, I am the *Aśvattha* (sacred fig); among the Devarṣis, I am Nārada; among the Gandharvas, I am Citraratha; and among the Siddhas, I am the sage Kapila.

Mananam Śloka - 25

Among the three *guṇas* in nature, which can be considered the most fitting representation of divinity in holy ones and sages? Why is *Om* regarded as the most sacred of all syllables? Is it purely a matter of faith and tradition, or could there be a deeper mental and spiritual significance to it? How can *japa* (the repetition of a *mantra*) be considered a form of *yajña* (sacrifice)? What exactly are we offering when silently repeating a *mantra*? Why did the Lord choose the Himalayas to symbolize stillness? How can the physical stillness of a mountain influence my mind?

Self Reflection

Inspiration

In this *śloka*, the Supreme Being is meditated upon through the manifestations of *Ṛṣi* Bhṛigu, *japa*, the sacred syllable *Om*, and the Himalayas. If all the *ṛṣis* embody *sattvic* energy, then God is the purest and highest expression of *sattva*. Likewise, the ancient practice of *japa*, the chanting of *Om*, and the stillness of the Himalayas each serve as pathways to connect with the divine presence within us.

उच्चैःश्रवसमश्वानां विद्धि माममृतोद्भवम् ।

ऐरावतं गजेन्द्राणां नराणां च नराधिपम् ॥ १०.२७ ॥

uccaiḥśravasamaśvānām viddhi māmamṛtodbhavam ।
airāvataṁ gajēndrāṇām narāṇām ca narādhipam ॥ 10.27 ॥

Among horses, know Me as Uccaiḥśravas, born of *amṛta* (nectar); among elephants, I am Airāvata; and among men, I am the king.

आयुधानामहं वज्रं धेनूनामस्मि कामधुक ।

प्रजनश्चास्मि कन्दर्पः सर्पाणामस्मि वासुकिः ॥ १०.२८ ॥

āyudhānāmahaṁ vajraṁ dhēnūnāmasmi kāmadhuk ।
prajanaścāsmi kandarpaḥ sarpāṇāmasmi vāsukiḥ ॥ 10.28 ॥

Among weapons, I am the Vajra (thunderbolt); among cows, I am Kāmadhuk (the wish-fulfilling cow); among causes of procreation, I am Kandarpa (the god of love); and among serpents, I am Vāsuki.

अनन्तश्चास्मि नागानां वरुणो यादसामहम् ।

पितृणामर्यमा चास्मि यमः संयमतामहम् ॥ १०.२९ ॥

anantaścāsmi nāgānām varuṇo yādasāmaham ।
piṭṛṇāmaryamā cāsmi yamaḥ saṁyamatāmaham ॥ 10.29 ॥

Among the *Nāgas*, I am Ananta; among the *Yādasas* (aquatic beings), I am Varuṇa; among the *piṭṛs* (ancestors), I am Aryamā; and among the *saṁyamatām* (controllers), I am Yama.

प्रह्लादश्चास्मि दैत्यानां कालः कलयतामहम् ।

मृगाणां च मृगेन्द्रोऽहं वैनतेयश्च पक्षिणाम् ॥ १०.३० ॥

prahlādaścāsmi daityānām kālaḥ kalayatāmaham ।
mṛgāṇām ca mṛgēndrō'haṁ vainatēyaśca pakṣiṇām ॥ 10.30 ॥

Among the *Daityas*, I am *Prahlāda*; among the *Kalayatām* (reckoners of time), I am *Kāla* (time); among the *Mṛgāṇām* (beasts), I am the *Mṛgendra* (lion); and among the *Pakṣiṇām* (birds), I am *Vainateya* (Garuḍa).

पवनः पवतामस्मि रामः शस्त्रभृतामहम् ।

झषाणां मकरश्चास्मि स्रोतसामस्मि जाह्नवी ॥ १०.३१ ॥

pavanah pavatāmasmi rāmaḥ śastrabhṛtāmaham ।

jhaṣāṇāṁ makaraścāsmi srōtasāmasmi jāhnavī ॥ 10.31 ॥

Among purifiers I am the Pavana (Wind); among wielders of weapons, I am Lord Rāma. Among aquatic creatures I am the Shark, and among flowing rivers I am Jāhnavī (daughter of Jahnu, Ganges).

सर्गाणामादिरन्तश्च मध्यं चैवाहमर्जुन ।

अध्यात्मविद्या विद्यानां वादः प्रवदतामहम् ॥ १०.३२ ॥

sargāṇāmādirantaśca madhyaṁ caivāhamarjuna ।

adhyātmavidyā vidyānāṁ vādaḥ pravadatāmaham ॥ 10.32 ॥

Of the *sargāṇām* (creations), I am the beginning, the end, and also the middle, O Arjuna; among knowledges, I am the *adhyātmavidyā*, Self-knowledge; and among the *pravadatām* (disputants), I am *vāda* (reasoned debate).

अक्षराणामकारोऽस्मि द्वन्द्वः सामासिकस्य च ।

अहमेवाक्षयः कालो धाताहं विश्वतोमुखः ॥ १०.३३ ॥

akṣarāṇāmakārō'smi dvandvaḥ sāmāsikasya ca ।

ahamēvākṣayaḥ kālō dhātāhaṁ viśvatōmukhaḥ ॥ 10.33 ॥

Among the alphabets, I am *akāra*, the letter 'A'; among the compounds, I am the *dvandva*, dual compound; I alone am *kāla*, eternal time; and I am the *dhātā*, dispenser (of fruits of actions), having faces in all directions.

मृत्युः सर्वहरश्चाहमुद्भवश्च भविष्यताम् ।

कीर्तिः श्रीर्वाक् नारीणां स्मृतिर्मेधा धृतिः क्षमा ॥ १०.३४ ॥

mṛtyuḥ sarvaharaścāhamudbhavaśca bhaviṣyatām ।

kīrtiḥ śrīrvākca nārīṇāṁ smṛtirmēdhā dhṛtiḥ kṣamā ॥ 10.34 ॥

I am all-devouring death, and I am the origin of those yet to be born (alternatively—[I am] the prosperity of those who are to be prosperous). Among feminine qualities, I am fame, prosperity, fine speech, memory, intelligence, steadfastness, and forbearance.

Mananam Śloka – 31, 32

Why is wind regarded as a purifying agent? How can this cleansing quality of wind be seen as a representation of the Lord for meditation? What makes the Ganga so sacred that it is chosen as the ideal representation of the Divine among all rivers? Why is Self-knowledge considered the most precious form of wisdom? How does the knowledge of the Self relate to the knowledge of the Lord? Are these two separate truths to be known and realised, or are they interconnected?

Self Reflection***Inspiration***

The passing wind and the flowing river are both manifestations of the Lord in dynamic activity. To be active means constant movement and change. If nature were stagnant, it would lack the richness and vitality of creation. Yet, recognising the unchanging Lord within the ever-changing flow of nature brings deep solace to the devotee's heart. Seeking the Self is the highest pursuit of human life. Of what value is the knowledge of countless things if one remains unaware of the very source that makes all "knowing" and "learning" possible? To realise "Who am I?" is not only the pinnacle of wisdom but the only knowledge that quiets restless curiosity—the force that drives us outward, leaving us perpetually unsatisfied.

Mananam Śloka - 34

Why is death described as that which takes everything away? How can this phenomenon represent a manifestation of the all-powerful divine presence in creation? How can the same Lord who takes everything away also be the one who bestows prosperity? What is the significance of potentiality, expressed through the use of the future tense, in the context of bestowing prosperity? Why are qualities such as fame, wealth, memory, intelligence, firmness, and forgiveness considered feminine? Does this imply that men cannot aspire to cultivate these virtues?

Self Reflection

Inspiration

Nearly all humans fear authorities and laws that can exercise power over us. While such power, whether legal or illegal, can strip us of wealth, possessions, and freedom, the highest power is the one capable of taking life itself. Likewise, the ultimate power is also the pinnacle of opulence. The Lord, as the giver of life, holds the potential to bless even those who are poor and deprived of worldly possessions with prosperity and abundance. These *mantras* serve as a profound meditation on the glory of the Lord—not only as the one who can take life away but also as the giver who breathes new life into a mother's womb or causes a seed to sprout into a plant or tree.

बृहत्साम तथा साम्नां गायत्री च्छन्दसामहम् ।

मासानां मार्गशीर्षोऽहमृतूनां कुसुमाकरः ॥ १०.३५ ॥

bṛhatsāma tathā sāmnaṁ gāyatrī cchandasāmaham ।
māsānāṁ mārgaśīrṣō:'hamṛtūnāṁ kusumākaraḥ ॥ 10.35 ॥

Among the hymns in the *Sāma veda*, I am the *bṛihat-sāma* (a specific hymn in the *Sāma veda*); of all poetic meters, I am the *gāyatrī*; of months, I am *mārgaśhīrṣha* (approx. November–December); of seasons, I am spring, the season of flowers.

द्यूतं छलयतामस्मि तेजस्तेजस्विनामहम् ।

जयोऽस्मि व्यवसायोऽस्मि सत्त्वं सत्त्ववतामहम् ॥ १०.३६ ॥

dyūtaṁ chalayatāmasmi tējastējasvināmaham ।
jayō:'smi vyavasāyō:'smi sattvaṁ sattvavatāmaham ॥ 10.36 ॥

I am the gambling of the deceitful, and the splendour of the splendid. I am victory, I am determination, and I am the *sattva* quality of those possessed of *sattva*.

वृष्णीनां वासुदेवोऽस्मि पाण्डवानां धनञ्जयः ।

मुनीनामप्यहं व्यासः कवीनामुशना कविः ॥ १०.३७ ॥

vṛṣṇīnāṁ vāsudēvō:'smi pāṇḍavānāṁ dhanañjayaḥ ।
munīnāmapyahaṁ vyāsaḥ kavīnāmuśanā kaviḥ ॥ 10.37 ॥

Among the descendants of *Vṛṣhṇī*, I am *Vāsudeva* (son of Vasudeva, Krishna); among the *Pāṇḍavās*, I am *Dhanañjaya* (the winner of wealth, Arjuna). Among the sages, I am *Vyāsa*, and among great thinkers, I am *Uśhanā*.

दण्डो दमयतामस्मि नीतिरस्मि जिगीषताम् ।

मौनं चैवास्मि गुह्यानां ज्ञानं ज्ञानवतामहम् ॥ १०.३८ ॥

daṇḍō damayatāmasmi nītirasmi jigīṣatām ।
maunaṁ caivāsmi guhyānāṁ
jñānaṁ jñānavatāmaham ॥ 10.38 ॥

Among those who enforce discipline, I am the rod of punishment (instrument of discipline); among those who seek victory, I am statesmanship (morality); of secrets, I am silence (*mauna*), and of the wise, I am wisdom (*jñāna*) itself.

Mananam Śloka – 36

How can the Supreme Being manifest as manipulation and deceit among gamblers? Isn't it contradictory that the one worshipped and adored in a personal form can also express such undesirable qualities? Can the God we revere, while displaying such qualities, remain pure and untainted by them? How is the Lord the manifestation of victory? Isn't victory often associated with glory and achievement? How is the Lord the essence of goodness and purity? What in my worldly experiences can I identify as the highest expression of goodness? Can I use that experience or entity as a guide for meditating on the Lord?

Self Reflection

Inspiration

When the Supreme Spirit manifests in nature, it can take on any extreme form (for all forms and qualities ultimately belong to the manifest God). Only the Supreme can be powerful enough to counter and overcome even the most deceitful and destructive of forces. The scriptures teach that among all illusions, *maya* plays the greatest trick, for it veils the reality of the Lord from our awareness. Though the pure Spirit can manifest as both good and bad, it remains valuable for a seeker to revere the Lord as the pinnacle of goodness and purity. By doing so, one cultivates and expresses those virtues within oneself. *Sattva* (purity) leads toward freedom and liberation, while *tamas* (inertia) binds us more deeply to ignorance. Both arise from the Lord's nature but do not stain or diminish the essence of the Divine.

Mananam Śloka – 38

Is it possible that God administers justice and punishes those who harm the innocent and pious? Do I believe that the divine *avatāras* who manifested in order to destroy evil and wickedness were real historical figures, or do I see them more as symbolic stories? Why is silence considered the greatest secret? Can it reveal truths that are too profound or ineffable to be expressed in words? What is the highest form of knowledge that one can possess? Can a person study and retain all knowledge of the material world throughout life? Is there an essential wisdom that serves as the key to understanding all fields of study?

Self Reflection

Inspiration

Nearly all religions uphold a belief in some form of divine retribution. Whether through a direct act of God or the precise workings of *karmic* law, those who persist in evil intentions and actions inevitably face the consequences of their deeds. Therefore, it is wiser to seek justice through God or the divine force governing creation. *Munis* are those who have mastered control over their speech and minds. In the profound silence they cultivate, they uncover the deeper mysteries of creation and the realms beyond. True knowledge encompasses the understanding of God, creation, and, most importantly, our own being. It is this essential knowingness—the subjective awareness within—that empowers us to perceive and comprehend all objective knowledge.

यच्चापि सर्वभूतानां बीजं तदहमर्जुन ।

न तदस्ति विना यत्स्यान्मया भूतं चराचरम् ॥ १०.३९ ॥

yaccāpi sarvabhūtānāṃ bījaṃ tadahamarjuna ।
na tadasti vinā yatsyānmayā bhūtaṃ carācaram ॥ 10.39 ॥

Furthermore, O Arjuna, I am the *bījaṃ*, seed, of all beings. There is no being—whether moving or non-moving—that can exist without Me.

नान्तोऽस्ति मम दिव्यानां विभूतीनां परन्तप ।

एष तूद्देशतः प्रोक्तो विभूतेर्विस्तरो मया ॥ १०.४० ॥

nāntō:'sti mama divyānāṃ vibhūtīnāṃ parantapa ।
ēṣa tūddēśataḥ prōktō vibhūtērvistarō mayā ॥ 10.40 ॥

O Parantapa (conqueror of enemies, Arjuna) there is no end to My *divyānām vibhūtīnām*, divine manifestations. What I have described to you is but a brief account of My *vibhūti*, glories.

यद्यद्विभूतिमत्सत्त्वं श्रीमदूर्जितमेव वा ।

तत्तदेवावगच्छ त्वं मम तेजोऽसम्भवम् ॥ १०.४१ ॥

yadyadvibhūtimatsattvaṃ śrīmadūrjitamēva vā ।
tattadēvāvagaccha tvaṃ mama tējōśasambhavam ॥ 10.41 ॥

Know that whatever is glorious, prosperous, or mighty in this world is but a portion of My own splendour.

अथवा बहुनैतेन किं ज्ञातेन तवार्जुन ।

विष्टभ्याहमिदं कृत्स्नमेकांशेन स्थितो जगत् ॥ १०.४२ ॥

athavā bahunaitēna kiṃ jñātēna tavārjuna ।
viṣṭabhyāhamidaṃ kṛtsnamēkāṃśēna sthithō jagat ॥ 10.42 ॥

But what is the need for all this detailed knowledge, O Arjuna? Simply know that I pervade and support this entire universe with just one part of Myself.

Mananam Śloka – 39, 40

If God is the seed of all beings, does that mean that everything in creation is a manifestation of the Divine? Can I see the presence of God in every aspect of nature and life around me? Doesn't all matter have a traceable origin? Just as science identifies atoms as the fundamental units of matter, could there also be a divine essence as the ultimate source of everything and everyone? Has human science been able to trace the origin of the energy that keeps matter in motion or sustains it in stillness? Is it possible to keep tracing the source of creation in a hierarchical order? Will there ever be a definitive end to this search for the ultimate source?

Self Reflection***Inspiration***

Even what science describes as energy or the initial spark of the Big Bang must have its origin in some preceding God-particle or primal source. The human mind, with its inherent limitations, tends to seek finite units to define the infinite. Yet, the true essence of God transcends all such boundaries and cannot be confined to intellectual definitions. The glories and manifestations of the Divine are beyond the grasp of the ordinary human mind. Only when the intellect is elevated to a divine state—when it merges with higher wisdom—can the profound mysteries of matter, energy, and existence be fully revealed.

Mananam Śloka - 41, 42

Whenever I see someone powerful, talented, or rich, do I realise that it is a manifestation of the Divine potential? Time has shown that despite one human who may be great and special, someone else comes along and shows a higher greatness. Have I considered why world records get broken frequently? Is there a record that will never be broken? Is it possible that God is the epitome of all that we admire in people and in nature? Is it also possible that all the talent, power and riches in the world are not anyone's own, but borrowed from the Supreme Being? Can this Supreme Being be the essential basis for everything in this universe?

Self Reflection***Inspiration***

All the great qualities and talents we admire in people, all the powers that one might have, all the riches that one may possess, are all a manifestation of the Supreme Being. In the Lord's creation, there are unlimited and undreamed-of possibilities. All of the universes that we know speculate about are only a small portion of the Divine Being. Without God, nothing exists. A wise devotee is one who learns to use every spectacle as a meditation pointer toward the Lord. Furthermore, the devotee realises that deep within is that supremely creative and manifesting force of the Divine to transform all the unhealthy and negative conditions in life.

इति श्रीमद्भगवद्गीतासूपनिषत्सु ब्रह्मविद्यायां योगशास्त्रे श्रीकृष्णार्जुनसंवादे
विभूतियोगो नाम दशमोऽध्यायः ॥

ōṃ tatsaditi śrīmadbhagavadgītāsūpaniṣatsu brahmavidyāyāṃ
yōgaśāstrē śrīkṛṣṇārjunasaṃvādē vibhūtiyōgō nāma
daśamō'dhyāyaḥ ॥



IAST Sanskrit

Devanagari	IAST	Usage
अ	a	a o in "son"
आ	ā	as in "master"
इ	i	as in "if"
ई	ī	as in "feel"
उ	u	as in "full"
ऊ	ū	as in "boot"
ऋ	ṛ	as in r and ri
ए	e	as in "evade"
ऐ	ai	as y in "my"
ओ	o	as in "owe"
औ	au	as in "out"
क	ka	as in "cup"
ख	kha	like "kh" in "backhand"
ग	ga	as in "gun"
घ	gha	like "gh" in "ghost"
ङ	ṅa	as "ng" in "sing"
च	ca	as "ch" in "chair"
छ	cha	as in "church"
ज	ja	as "j" in "jump"
झ	jha	jh as in "hedgehog"
ञ	ña	like "ny" in "canyon"
ट	ṭa	as in "tounge"

Devanagari	IAST	Usage
ठ	ṭha	as in "thought"
ड	ḍa	as in "doodle"
ढ	ḍha	as in "godhood"
ण	ṇa	as in "under"
त	ta	as in "tongue"
थ	tha	as in "thought"
द	da	as in "then"
ध	dha	as in "breathe"
न	na	as in "name"
प	pa	as in "cup"
फ	pha	as in "phone"
ब	ba	as in "ball"
भ	bha	as in "abhor"
म	ma	as in "man"
य	ya	as in "year"
र	ra	as in "run"
ल	la	as in "light"
व	va	as in "water"
श	śa	as in "ship"
ष	ṣa	as in "shoe"
स	sa	as in "sun"
ह	ha	as in "hot"
ं	ṁ	as in "ring"
ः	ḥ	as in "hath"
ँ	ṁ	as in "mukha"
ॐ	om	as in "om"
ऽ	'	as in "agni"



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